



Rulebook

The Rulebook of Seven-Part Pact

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Introduction

The seven greatest wizards in the world convene upon the Faraway Sea, their magic aligned in the service of an ancient Pact. Each governs one seventh of this world and wields power beyond comprehension over the very fabric of the cosmos. While these wizards are indeed mighty, so too are they trapped: by the pressures of masculinity, by the weight of their loneliness, by the tolling bell of their own mortality. Each has a choice: will he maintain the systems which imprison him, or will he rebel against his pact and destroy the fragile balance of his world?

Seven-Part Pact is a tabletop roleplaying game for up to seven players (including the Facilitator) about the might and folly of powerful wizards. Each player takes charge of a **codex**: one of seven books which detail one of these wizards and their portion of the world. The codex covers two subjects: the history, life, and responsibilities of the player's wizard, and the player's position in the **Celestial Audience**, who collectively narrate the world around the other wizards and present them with new challenges. Each wizard is responsible for a magical **Domain**, represented by a board that abstracts the movements of power and control through their lands. Each wizard also has access to the shared central **Grimoire**: a massive book of spells which any wizard may use to perform miraculous feats and change the very rules of the game itself.

This is the **Rulebook**. Within this volume are the rules for play which all wizards must follow, instructions for setting up **Seven-Part Pact** for both digital and analog play, and universal reference materials used during play itself.

Foundation of the Pact

Magic, in its final days, dwells upon *the archipelago of Isha*, a thousand miles upon the Faraway Sea. It is a bucolic land, as beautiful as it is doomed. Imagine: perfect green emeralds cradled among the waves, each adorned with marvelous columns and impossible spires. The isles of Isha are lands of colorful sails and hot baths, of proud statues and mossy graves, of winding staircases along cliffs of volcanic stone, and of magic. And watching over it all, under the auspice of their pact, are the wizards of Isha.

You will play as these **seven wizards**, mortal men blessed and cursed with stewardship of magic in this uncertain age, and the incredible power which accompanies such authority. Through your words the dead will rise, the stars will fall, the seas will burn, and the gods themselves will tremble at your power.

Legends say the first **wizard-kings** sculpted the world as it is now, wielding the flame of the gods to lift up islands and construct great kingdoms across the Faraway Sea and beyond. These wizards are gone now, their kingdoms rubble, their towers a cautionary tale. In their hubris they turned upon one another, and the name of that war is seared into the records of history.

They now call it **The Tragedies**, for there are few words that can capture the scale of the violence wrought upon the world by those few unlucky enough to survive the calamity. It was **The Pact**

which saved mankind: seven wizards came together atop a fallen star and swore an oath to protect magic and each other. It was Isha where the Pact was signed, and from that day forward, the archipelago of Isha would serve as the last sanctuary of magic, where it must be guarded by those responsible for its power.

It has been many years since the Tragedies, and Isha has seen many changes in the intervening years. Its history is chronicled in **Ages**, each representing different relationships with magic. The archipelago has suffered through ages of war and been rewarded with ages of plenty. It has grown fat and bountiful upon the hand of wizards, and wepted bitter tears at the cruelty meted by this same hand. Isha's history is storied and vast, and its nature is shaped by the Age.

The Nature of Wizards

Wizards are mighty, powerful enough to destroy the world. A Wizard is never "too weak" — all magic lies within his grasp, and there is nothing stopping a Wizard from unleashing incredible destruction upon all creation besides his own wisdom and a healthy fear of the consequences.

Wizards are men, without exception. It is well known that women cannot practice magic. There are rumors that some members of the Seven-Part Pact might not keep to this, but no one would dare accuse an honorable man of practicing such deception.

Wizards are lonely, for there is no one who may understand a Wizard's great responsibility. He is accompanied by very few; his wife if he's lucky, his friends if he's even more lucky. The incredible knowledge and burden of magic drives them away from the common folk, into a deep seclusion. The only people who might understand a Wizard's feelings are his fellow Wizards, who are obnoxious and insufferable creatures.

Wizards are mortal, despite their best efforts. The only resource a wizard lacks in abundance, the only treasure which the wizard cannot simply conjure, is time. Death has a way of claiming each Wizard eventually, no matter how many spells he may cast to prolong his life. Wizards will spend their entire lives vying for control of their destiny, as they refuse to go quietly into their death.

The Seven Wizards of the Pact

The seven wizards of the Pact have each been entrusted with a Domain. While the power of these Domains may rise and fall over the ages, and while the Pact may go generations without all seven seats filled, these responsibilities stand eternal.

The Necromancer was entrusted with the gloomy gates of Death, and guards their boundaries from those who seek to pervert the laws of life and death. He is the Watcher of the Gates, Skull-Bearer, and the Grim Lord of Death. *Choose the Necromancer if you want to fight against the armies of the dead, challenge the Pact with deadly circumstances, or to dwell on grief and loss.*

The Hierophant was entrusted with the immortal flames of the sacred temples of Isha, and guides the common people of the archipelago. He is the Watcher of the Flames, Grail-Bearer, and the Blessed Lord of Hope. *Choose the Hierophant if you want to give a voice to the common folk, defend the interests of the community surrounding your fellow Wizards, or to dwell on spirituality and community.*

The Warlock was entrusted with the royal throne of Isha, and guides the bickering clans and nobility which maintains peace across the archipelago. He is the Watcher of the Thrones, Blade-Bearer, and the Furious Lord of Lords. *Choose the Warlock if you want to manipulate the politics of the kingdom, maintain the pressure of violence and society, or dwell on authority and masculinity.*

The Mariner was entrusted with the seas and skies of Isha, and guides the merchant vessels and trade ships which connect the archipelago. He is the Watcher of the Storms, Stave-Bearer, and the Distant Lord of Beasts. *Choose the Mariner if you want to manage the ecosystem of Isha, explore distant lands far beyond the Pact, or dwell on the natural world and how it shapes us.*

The Faustian was entrusted with the Devil, the enemy of magic, and safeguards the Pact from his machinations. He is the Watcher of the Chains, Key-Bearer, and the Doomed Lord of Hell. *Choose the Faustian if you want to bargain with (and as) the Devil, present challenges the rest of the Pact must overcome, or struggle against the inevitability of your collapse.*

The Sage was entrusted with the shared dream of the future, the careful balance of cosmic destiny, and guides the inevitable fate of the Pact away from nightmares and disaster. He is the Watcher of the Stars, Jewel-Bearer, and the Hermetic Lord of Dreams. *Choose the Sage if you want to sculpt the future of the Pact, weave together the scattered fragments of play into a single narrative, and determine what happens when the game ends.*

The Sorcerer was entrusted with magic itself, and uses the Pact to advance magic and uncover forgotten secrets, growing his tower ever higher with academic insight. He is the Watcher of the Truth, Crown-Bearer, and the Great Lord of Magic. *Choose the Sorcerer if you want to explore the deepest lore of the setting, debate the text of the game itself, or try to maintain control over a chaotic and unpredictable world.*

Overview of Play

To prepare for play, the players will each choose a wizard to play and collectively select an appropriate Age based on their skill level, experience, and interests. The players will use this Age, in combination with their wizard's codex, to prepare their characters, their community, their Domains, and the broader world.

The game is divided into periods of time (**months**) which the players will collectively explore. A central **Orrery** in the middle of the table displays the position of the stars and planets in the night sky, which in turn influence the Domains of each wizard. These Domains are each a separate boardgame, which represent different aspects of the world of the Pact. Domains without stewardship trend towards chaos, and as they collapse they bring hardship onto their adjacent Domains.

During the month, each player chooses how their wizard spends his **Time**, using his weeks to tend to his Domain, care for his **Companions**, research the secrets of his **Isle** and **Sanctum**, converse with fellow wizards, manipulate the Orrery, or perform various acts of magic. Magic is the tool which allows wizards to break the rules of the natural world, shared by the wizard's **Elements** and **Treasures**, but its careless use also threatens to produce further complications for the Pact. True and powerful magic, for the most part, can only be cast during **scenes** between the wizard and other characters.

While each player embodies their wizard, they are also responsible for their part in the **Celestial Audience**: the council of impartial fates which referee the mechanisms of the world. While a player acts as their wizard, they pursue their own goals and objectives within the confines of the game. When a player acts as part of the Celestial Audience, they present challenges for other wizards and obstruct their goals.

Once a month is complete, a new month begins, and play continues. Stories will emerge and resolve, characters will experience highs and lows, and the whirring machine of fate will slowly reveal the destiny of the Pact. A **campaign** of ***Seven-Part Pact*** therefore will cover many months (or even years!) of events, which will be experienced over the course of multiple **sessions**.

Three Roles

When you play ***Seven-Part Pact***, you embody three roles, to varying degrees at various times.

- **You are a wizard of the Pact.** As your wizard, you strive towards your character's goals and represent their perspective within the fiction.
- **You are a Watcher of the Celestial Audience.** As a Watcher, you faithfully represent the nature of the world, present obstacles to the wizards of the pact, and embody other characters connected to your Domain.
- **You are a player at the table.** As yourself, you take care of your own comfort, health, and pleasure, and advocate for yourself and others at the table.

Your wizard may bellyache and groan when his evil schemes are thwarted, but as a player you may be delighted and thrilled. As Watcher you may lay out a monstrous trap for another wizard, causing him tremendous grief and misery, but the whole time the two players are high-fiving about it. As a player you can understand that a system in which only men are wizards is faulty and useless, but as the Watcher you may be the one enforcing it onto the Pact, or as your wizard you may act as a horrible person in order to maintain that same system. [footnote: ***Seven-Part Pact*** is at its most interesting when the interests of the player, their wizard, and their Watcher role fail to align.]

When your wizard isn't in a scene, you play as part of the Celestial Audience and fulfill your Watcher role. If your wizard is active in a scene, you may hand off your Watcher role to other players in order to obtain their perspective and avoid having to describe acting immediately against yourself. [footnote: It's not very enjoyable to be the author of one's own adversity — this is a concept known as the Czege Principle. While a player is generally inseparable from their Watcher role, temporarily handing it to another player allows a wizard to fight against his own Domain without violating the Czege Principle.]

The Facilitator [box]

One player is also the **Facilitator**. The Facilitator is the player who (probably) owns the copy of the game, is (probably) the most excited to be playing, and is (probably) the most experienced with the rules. If you're the Facilitator, you're responsible for introducing the game to the rest of the players, helping them make choices and prepare for play, and walking them through aspects of play. The Facilitator has no special responsibilities within the game itself. If you're the Facilitator, I encourage you to ask your fellow players for support: who can bring snacks to the game? Who can manage scheduling? Who has the experience to help other players?

Preparation

The difference between a man and a wizard is often in his preparation. Before your group begins playing **Seven-Part Pact** in earnest, you must go through and prepare, setting up materials, creating wizards, and choosing the Age.

Choosing an Age

Seven-Part Pact is heavily shaped by Ages, scenarios that provide the starting conditions for the Pact and provide different situations for the Pact to begin from. Some Ages are better suited for groups just beginning, while others are set up for experienced Pacts.

The Ages contained within this rulebook are:

- **The Age of Awakening (page XXXX)**, for 3-7 beginning or intermediate players, an introductory setup for starting a long-term campaign.
- **The Age of Dominion (page XXXX)**, for 3-7 experienced players, an advanced setup for starting a long-term campaign.
- **The Age of Calamity (page XXXX)**, for 7 expert players, a tightly-wound self-contained scenario that pushes the Pact to its limits.

Once an Age is chosen, information within the Age will inform setting up the remainder of the game.

Notes About Content [box]

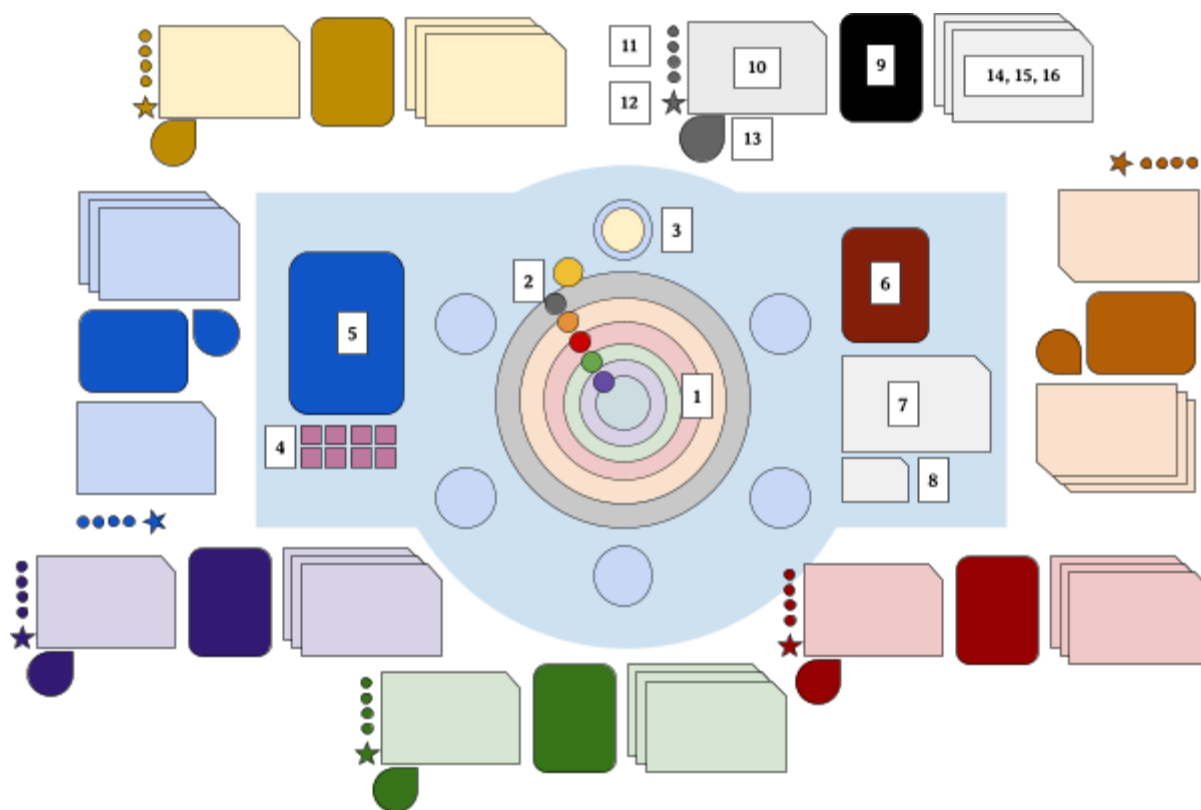
Seven-Part Pact does not itself require seven players. However, should fewer than seven players sit around the table, certain adjustments must be made.

Take the excess Celestial Audience roles and assign them to wizards comfortable taking up the additional responsibility during scenes. For more information on the Watchers of the Celestial Audience, see page XXXX.

Then determine through the rules of the Age whether the wizards lacking players are Silent or Absent. A Silent wizard is doing his job responsibly in the background of the game, rarely showing his face to the Pact. An Absent wizard is missing, their Pact-Fragment unclaimed, their role unoccupied. Should the Silent or Absent wizard ever suffer a Complication, instead redirect that Complication onto any Present wizard. More information about Silent and Absent wizards can be found on page XXXX.

Arranging Materials

[description: A diagram of the arranged materials for play. The materials are arranged and numbered as described in the accompanying text.]



At the center of the table, place **The Orrery** [1], with the **Celestial Bodies** [2] placed in their tracks (as determined by the Age) and the **Moon** [3] on the *New Moon Phase*. To the west, place the **Dice** [4] in a bowl or cup accompanied by *The Grimoire* [5], and to the east, place *The Rulebook* [6], *The Palette* [7] and a stack of **index cards** [8] (or scrap paper with pencils). Starting in the north and proceeding clockwise around the edge of the table, arrange each **codex** [9]. Accompanying each wizard's codex, place the wizard's **Domain Materials** [10], **Time tokens** [11], **Engagement token** [12], **Pact-Fragment** [13], **Character Sheet** [14], **Map** [15], and **Watcher Sheet** [16].

Place votive candles, incense, animal bones, grails, crystals, seashells, flower petals, golden coins, runes, and other arcane components throughout the play space as deemed appropriate. Distribute snacks and drinks over the course of play.

Each player should additionally bring (or be provided with) one or more pencils and a notebook.

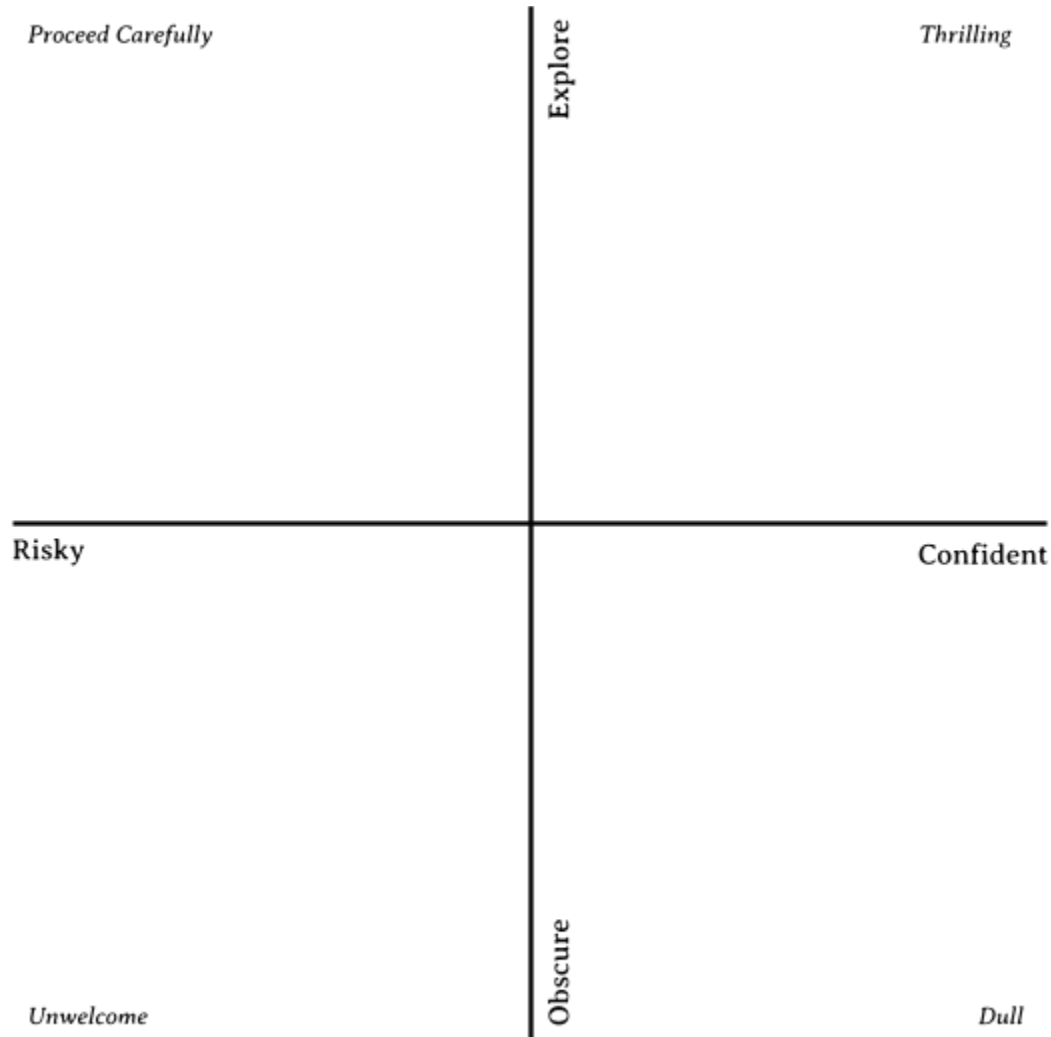
Discussing Expectations

While we may play isolationist, miserable, hostile old men during the game, as players you have an obligation to communicate clearly with each other about your intentions. There are certain

themes in ***Seven-Part Pact*** that can be really compelling if everyone is on-board (such as generational trauma or dramatic romances) but can also be distressing and difficult if players are unprepared. While Isha is a chaotic and sometimes very dark world, you still have control over where the Celestial Audience focuses its attention. **The Palette Grid** is the *conversation tool* used by ***Seven-Part Pact*** to help establish your shared interests and where it's important to be wary and mindful of each others' needs.[footnote: Other approaches to conversation tools are discussed on page XXXX.]

The Palette Grid

[description: A blank graph with two axes. The horizontal one is labeled "Risky" on the left and "Confident" on the right. The vertical axis is labeled "Explore" on the top and "Obscure" on the bottom. The four quadrants (starting from the top left and proceeding clockwise) are labeled "Proceed Carefully", "Thrilling", "Dull", and "Unwelcome.". There's plenty of space on the graph to record words inside.]



The Palette Grid is composed of four quadrants. The horizontal line is based on how risky or confident the entire group is with the topic, and the vertical line instructs players on whether you want to explore the topic further or obscure it from your game. If something feels confident and you want to explore it, then full speed ahead! If something is risky but you want to explore it, proceed cautiously, and check in with your fellow players when the topic comes up. If something is confident but you want to obscure it, then the players find it to be dull, and you'll avoid it due to disinterest. If something is risky and you want to obscure it, then the players should stay far away from the topic.

Here is a list of topics which are likely to come up in **Seven-Part Pact**. Work together to identify where each topic should be placed in your Palette Grid, or break apart topics into sub-topics to be specific around particular aspects of these topics.

- Violence
- Patriarchy
- Discrimination
- Natural Disasters
- Body Horror
- Betrayal
- Sex

After listing these topics, work together to place other topics you're interested in. This is a good time to make requests around specific topics you want to avoid or you want to highlight as risky, or concepts you find compelling but you're worried other players at the table may be uninterested in. Periodically return and adjust the Palette during play.

Notes About Content [box]

Throughout the text of ***Seven-Part Pact*** are themes of misogyny, homophobia, and transphobia. Different themes, including complex and challenging ones that push at the limits of social acceptability, may emerge from play. As both wizards and the world around them, players will often find themselves on both the giving and receiving end of violence. Sometimes during the game a player may pause and realize that their character has just casually performed an act of mass violence, authoritarian surveillance, or monstrous social inequity. These moments can be compelling. ***Seven-Part Pact*** is frequently at its most interesting when players discuss and linger on the implications of their characters' actions.

Creating A Wizard

The Four Elements

The magical capacity and personality of a wizard is determined by his relationship to the four classical Elements. Each Element is a numerical value determined within Part 1 of each wizard's codex. Each player answers a series of questions regarding their wizard's personality and

impulses when placed in a series of hypothetical situations. These answers, alongside the shape of the wizard's Pact-Fragment and Familiar, determine the value of his Elements.

The four Elements are:

- **Air**, the Element of security, authority, and all that dwells in the sky above. Those with high Air are seen as powerful and assured, albeit often considered aloof and paranoid. A wizard cares for his Air Element through magical defenses, physical training, and time spent alone.
- **Fire**, the Element of creativity, inspiration, and all that dwells beyond the mortal world. Those with high Fire are seen as enlightened and artistic, albeit often considered eccentric and unreliable. A wizard cares for his Fire Element through philosophical debate, studied discovery, and artistic expression.
- **Earth**, the Element of diligence, reliability, and all that dwells upon the soil. Those with high Earth are seen as practical and secure, albeit often considered boring and understated. A wizard cares for his Earth Element through warm meals, cleanliness, and routine.
- **Water**, the Element of romanticism, community care, and all that dwells beneath the sea. Those with high Water are seen as compassionate and beloved, albeit often considered emotional and effeminate. A wizard cares for his Water Element through physical affection, banquets, and flirtatious rendezvous.

These Elements are the four pillars of a wizard's internal existence. They may fluctuate over the course of play, as the wizard's relationship with the world grows and changes. Whenever you have a spare moment, you may re-evaluate the choices you made for your wizard and see if his perspective has changed. If his answers would be different now, make new choices on his behalf — and adjust his Elements accordingly.

Elements and Internality [box]

Although there are emotional states associated with low or high quantities of an Element, these are not prescriptive. A wizard may have high Fire and yet still be creatively constipated — his internal instincts locked in conflict, unable to metastasize. Express your wizard as feels appropriate, for the rules of **Seven-Part Pact** can only gesture at his internality.

Pact-Fragment and Familiar

Each wizard possesses a Pact-Fragment, the physical manifestation of the power and authority granted to him by the Pact. Each Pact-Fragment exists in two forms — a true form, made from the wizard's associated metal, and a personal form, which responds to the needs and personality of its wizard. A wizard's possession of his Pact-Fragment is necessary for accomplishing many of the tasks of his station. Should a wizard ever lose his Pact-Fragment, he loses access to much of his power, limiting his magic and disrupting his responsibilities.

A wizard's Elements are also partially determined by his Familiar. A wizard's Familiar is a mundane creature bonded to the wizard's soul for the purpose of channeling and expressing his magic. Familiars assist wizards in their spellcasting, accompany them on their expeditions, and provide them company even when otherwise alone.

History, Secrets, & Treasures

While creating your wizard, you also make choices for him regarding his old master, his age, the changes magic have wrought upon him, his personal relationship with his masculinity, his treasures, and his name. As you make choices about your wizard, conspire with the other players to establish dramatic connections with other wizards — feuding masters, tormented pasts, shared loves, and melodramatic tension. [footnote: You may also choose to keep any of these aspects of your wizard a secret, a matter only for you and you alone. Just remember — all that is secret may someday be spoken.]

Changes of Magic [box]

The list of options around how one's wizard has been changed is referred to as his Changes of Magic. Occasionally **Seven-Part Pact** will give you chances to add to, expand, or alter this list.

Example of Play: Halmyrion Twinstar

In the month of March in the 17th year of the Age of Knives, Halmyrion Twinstar, Sorcerer of the Pact [**Watcher of the Truth and played by Ezra**], appeared upon the Orrery to speak with his fellows.

[Ezra goes through the Sorcerer's questions under Humor and Temperament. He determines his Sorcerer is a dismissive, arrogant, self-aggrandizing magpie. His Sorcerer also has a sturdy staff and a snake that lives on his shoulders. His Sorcerer's Elements are 3 Air, 1 Fire, 3 Earth, 1 Water. Ezra knows he did it correctly because a wizard's total Elements add up to 8.

He then decided everyone knows his old master fashioned himself the god of this world, and that it was his Sorcerer's choice to let him die through inaction. But secretly, he believes his master was a brilliant researcher, and the old Necromancer manipulated him into killing his master.

His wizard is two scores and a bit (43 years) old, meaning he has three Changes of Magic. Ezra decides his Sorcerer has stag antlers, floating books, and no eyes. Creepy!

Ezra's Sorcerer is a man. Everyone knows this. In truth, he once considered himself a woman, and the old Necromancer used this secret to manipulate him into killing his master. If anyone finds it out...he'll be ruined.

His name is one taken from the great wizards of history. Halmyrion!

"Hey Sara, how old is your Necromancer?" Ezra asks.]

Titles

Each wizard begins with three titles, determined by his role in the Pact. For instance, the Necromancer is the Keeper of the Gates, Bearer of the Skull, and the Grim Lord of Death. At the start of play, you will ask and be asked questions determined by the Age regarding the history and relationships of your wizards. These questions will confer new titles upon your wizards. These may be grandiose, imposing, monstrous, or tongue-in-cheek, depending on the context of how they were earned. [footnote: "The Wise" is most frequently earned, not through a display of wisdom, but instead via some especially egregious moment of careless stupidity. Those outside the Pact will frequently mistake it as an honorific, unaware of the inherent mockery in its tautology.] The youngest wizard within the Pact always bears the title "Neophyte," while the eldest wizard always bears the title "Archmagus."

Companions

While wizards fashion themselves isolated, in practice they depend on a network of associates and family to support their devotion to the magical arts. Each Wizard is accompanied by four

Companions, who provide emotional support and tend to different parts of their lives.

Companions are **Denizens** of this world; part of the assembly of characters who exist outside the seven wizards of the Pact. They have their own lives and perspectives, although they begin play loyal to their wizard. A wizard's Companions may include his wife, his child, his pupils, or even stranger bedfellows.

Each Companion is associated with a different Element, and provides a different form of care:

- His private life, providing security, relaxation, and a sense of freedom. (*Air*)
- His creative life, providing conversation, inspiration, and imagination. (*Fire*)
- His daily life, providing clean clothes, food, and a tidy sanctum. (*Earth*)
- His emotional life, providing intimacy, compassion, and comfort. (*Water*)

Each Companion faithfully provides their care in the background of each month, tending to the basic needs of the wizard they adore. Should one of your wizard's Companions ever depart, die, or become unwilling to take care of their Element, he must do so himself. Each month he may spend Time providing this missing care, perhaps through alcoholism, self-destructive bouts of violence, or by sleeping with sex workers in his Isle. Until he spends this Time, the associated Element will be reduced to 0 for the duration of the month.

Companions are created through Part 2 of each wizard's codex, and you may develop your Companions further when you have a spare moment.[footnote: In some games of **Seven-Part Pact**, a wizard's Companions may become characters of equal or even greater importance than their wizard, while in other games, it may take months before the Celestial Audience remembers a wizard has his wife back at home.]

Map of the Isle

A wizard's sanctum is his one refuge from the chaos of the world, the one place he can reliably return to in times of misery and uncertainty. It is often a haunted place, heavy with the weight of the past and the madness of past wizards. A home is a home, though, and a wizard seeks refuge where he may find it.

Each wizard has a Map of his isle, which begins as an outline with some vague markings indicating nearby shipping routes. Through Part 2 of your wizard's codex, you detail this isle further, marking down the Wizard's sanctum, nearby important locations, and the quarters of his Companions.

Your isle and sanctum also each have a list of **lore**, a series of bullet points which define various properties of the place. At the beginning of play, this description will depict a rundown sanctum on an uncomfortable isle. You may change the lore of your isle and sanctum, and add further details to your Map, over the course of play.

Setting Up The Domain

Each wizard has his own Domain, a board representing his perspective on the world. Each Domain is arranged differently, with different pieces representing different organizations, Denizens, and powers. Part 3 of each codex walks through what each Domain board represents and how to set it up, with variations depending on the Age. For each Domain, there are three variations:

- **Quiet:** A minimal starting position for the arrangement of the Domain. Represents an initially dormant or relaxed Domain.
- **Dynamic:** An entangled but not overly complex starting position. Represents a Domain starting *in media res*, with some tension historically kept under control.
- **Explosive:** A messy and complicated starting position. Represents a Domain starting at the edge of disaster, where any wrong move can cause the game to explode.

Refer to the Age to see how to prepare your wizard's Domain. [footnote: While the Ages included in this rulebook instruct symmetrical levels of complexity for the various Domains, other Ages may provide asymmetrical or custom starting positions.]

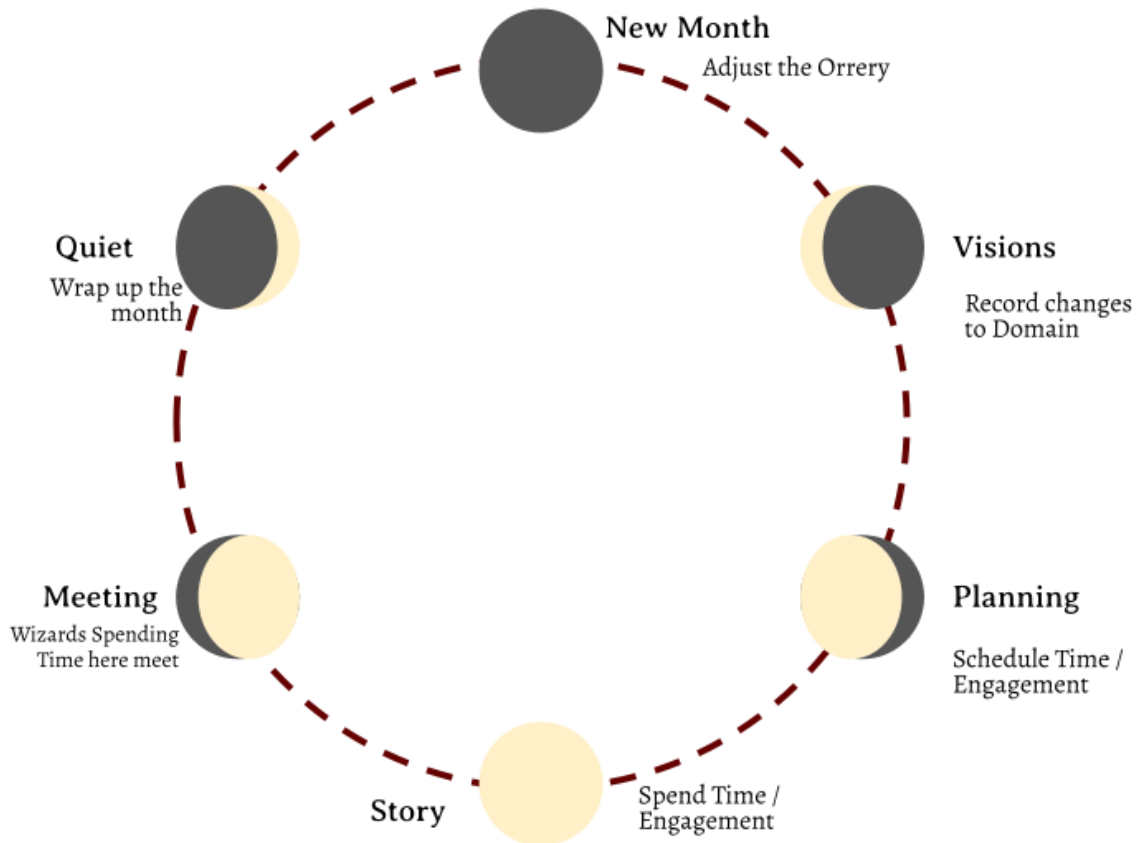
Playing *Seven-Part Pact*

The Pact's wizards have been invented, the Domains have been staged, the players are gathered and ready. This part of *The Rulebook* covers everything your group needs to know to perform the core loop of play, staging scenes during that, and casting magic.

The Phases of the Month

[description: Six moons arranged in a circle. Starting from the top, they are labeled: "New Month (adjust the Orrery)", "Visions (Record changes to Domain)", "Planning (Schedule

Time/Engagements)", "Story (Spend Time/Engagements)", "Meeting (Wizards Spending Time here meet)", and "Quiet (Wrap up the month)."]



Seven-Part Pact is divided into months, and each month is composed of Phases — each roughly corresponding with a phase of the moon. [footnote: One of the first machinations of the ancient wizards of the Ergoad, centuries before the establishment of the Pact, was to smartly sync the movement of the stars with the lunar phases. Before this period, each solar month was disconnected from its lunar cycle by around 8 days. This change also adjusted the months to align with their associated Zodiac.] The repetition of the structure of the month dictates the rhythm of play. They are:

- **The New Month Phase:** Advance the Orrery (page XXXX).
- **The Visions Phase:** Based on the position of the stars, each player makes adjustments to their Domain (pg XXXX).
- **The Planning Phase:** Each player **schedules** their wizard's Time and Engagement (page XXXX).

- **The Story Phase:** Going around the table, each wizard **spends** one of his scheduled Time or Engagement, proceeding until all scheduled Time is spent (page XXXX).
- **The Meeting Phase:** If a wizard's Scheduled Time for the **Wizardmoot**, he attends it (page XXXX).
- **The Quiet Phase:** The month ends and players take a break before the next month begins. Some players make adjustments to their Domains during this Phase.

The Orrery

In the fiction, The Orrery is a massive twisting structure of interlocking cogs and gears, held together by ancient and long-forgotten magic. At the game table, it is a playmat that sits between us, featuring a series of concentric circles with astrological labels. In both cases, it serves as an abstract representation of the position of stars in the sky.

The night sky is divided into twelve **Houses** of the **Zodiac**, each one roughly corresponding to one of the months of the year. Traversing these Houses are six **Celestial Bodies**. The Sun's position determines the current month. The **Arc** of each of the other Celestial Bodies represents the portion of the night sky that planet traverses during the month. At the start of each Month, all Celestial Bodies move clockwise (forward) a distance equal to their Arc. Speedy **Mercury** (♿) can circumnavigate the night sky in the time it takes quiet **Saturn** (♄) to make it through a House.

Interpreting the Orrery

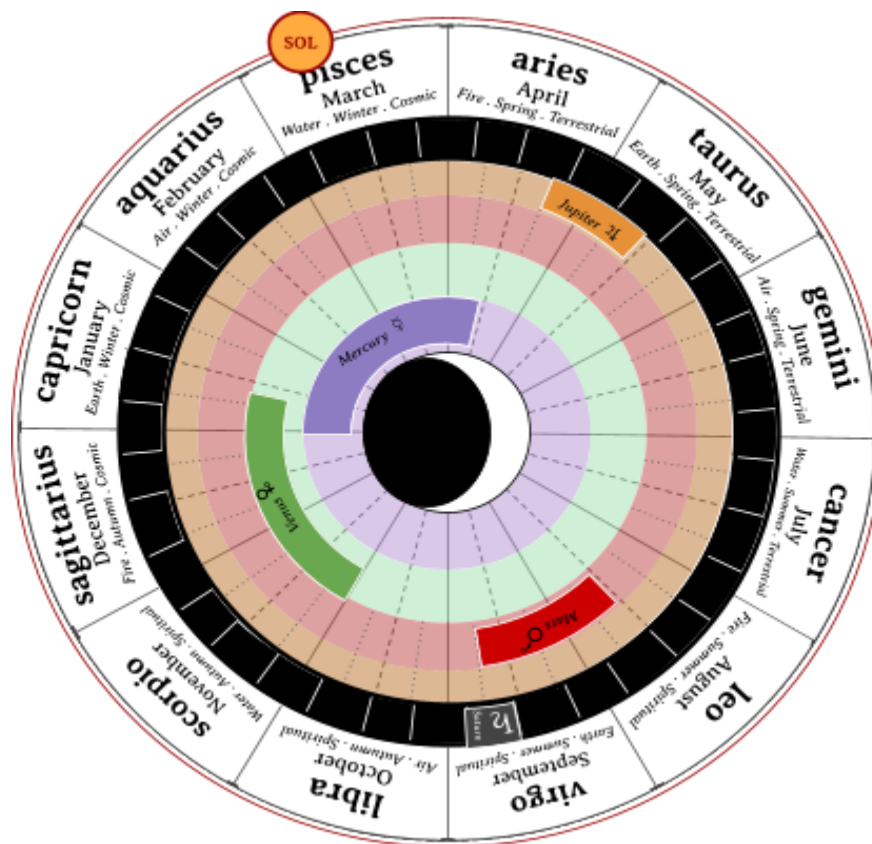
Each Domain responds differently to the movement of the planets, and yet their future can be ascertained through the position of the stars in the sky. During the Visions Phase, each player refers to the current position of the stars and compares this to the information provided for *Watching The Stars* in Part 3 of their codex.

A Celestial Body **lies within** a House if any portion of its Arc overlaps with that House. Two Celestial Bodies are **in conjunction** within a House if they both lie within that same House. [footnote: Celestial Bodies may be in conjunction even if their Arcs don't overlap with each other, as long as they both overlap with the House.]

Sample Orrery [box]

In this depiction of the Orrery, you can see **Mercury** (☿) currently lies within Capricorn, Aquarius, Pisces, and Aries. **Venus** (♀) currently lies within Scorpio, Sagittarius, and Capricorn. **Mars** (♂) currently lies within Leo and Virgo. **Jupiter** (♃) currently lies within Aries and Taurus. **Saturn** (♄) lies within Virgo. **The Sun** (☉) lies within Pisces, meaning it's currently March. Mars and Saturn are in conjunction. Mercury is in conjunction with Venus, Jupiter, and the Sun.

[description: A diagram of the Orrery, depicting the position of the Celestial Bodies as described in the sidebar.]



Weeks of Time

From the humblest farmer to the great sorcerers of Spyholm, all men have the same number of hours in their day. Time stands as one of the final stubborn holdouts of the cosmos against magic, and due to this, the capacity for wizards to act during a month is extremely limited. Each wizard has four weeks, represented by four Time tokens, to be spent on maintaining his Domain, entertaining his Companions, changing the lore of his isle, or in any number of other ways in the pursuit of his desires.

When a wizard schedules Time during the Planning Phase, his player places a Time token on the relevant associated game material. Players are encouraged to avoid coordinating around how they schedule their wizards' Time.

When a wizard spends Time during the Story Phase, his player removes the Time token from the game material and returns it to their possession. Briefly describe how this Time is spent for the Celestial Audience. [footnote: These narrative interludes associated with spending Time are by their nature short and to-the-point. In a full-sized game of **Seven-Part Pact**, each month will see between 21 and 28 tokens spent. You may collectively choose to devote more focus to this Time, elaborating on the description until each one is fully roleplayed out, with the knowledge that this focus will be accompanied with slower-paced months.]

During the Story Phase, going around the table, each wizard spends one week of Time. This cycle proceeds until all wizards have spent all their Time for the month.

Rescheduling Time [box]

Even the best-laid plans may go astray. A wizard may **reschedule** his Time in the middle of the month, moving one week of Time from one location to another. A wizard can only reschedule once a month, although leeway is encouraged for newer players learning the game. If a wizard has been left unable to spend his Time the way he intended (due to events arising over the course of the month), he can salvage a single week in this fashion, but any further Time is wasted.

Example of Play: The Necromancer's Wife

In the month of April in the 17th year of the Age of Knives, the Necromancer Rattletrap [played by Sara] planned out his month. He had a choice — should he schedule Time with his wife, or should he focus more on his responsibilities? He chose to schedule three of his four weeks amongst the Gates of Death, leaving his wife to pine after him. He spent that time over the course of the month. He only saw her briefly, when he arrived back from Death mud-soaked and dusty, and requested she wash his robes before departing to the Wizardmoot.

["Aren't you worried she might get resentful?" Asked the Flame-Watcher, for their responsibility governed the Companions of the Pact.

"Because of that extra week, I kept the Malbolge from escaping the Amber Gate and wreaking havoc across Isha. She should be grateful." Replied Sara, speaking in the voice of Rattletrap.

"But I can't blame her. He's kinda a jerk." Sara laughed in her regular voice.]

Ways to Spend Time

A wizard may schedule his Time upon any of the following places:

- On one of his Companions to benefit from their care. When he spends that Time, he gains +1 in the associated Element for the duration of the month.
- On his Map to explore, caretake, and maintain his home. When he spends that Time, he reveals something new on the Map and/or changes the lore of his isle or sanctum.
- On his Familiar to prepare his magic. When he spends that Time, he Patiently Casts a Spell (page XXXX).
- On the Orrery to travel there and manipulate its inner workings. When he spends that Time, he adjusts the position of any planet forward or backwards a distance equal to its Arc.
- On the Meeting Phase. All wizards who schedule Time in this fashion attend the Wizardmoot (page XXXX) during the Meeting Phase.
- On a multitude of different portions within his Domain, according to the rules of that Domain (Part 3 of the relevant codex).

There are other ways to spend Time which may be revealed over the course of play.

Pact-Fragments and Time [box]

As each wizard's Domain is different, so too differs the ways one spends their Time within it. Some aspects of a wizard's Domain may only be manipulated if the wizard has the Domain's associated Pact-Fragment. For instance, only the Necromancer may travel through the Gates of Death with the speed and confidence afforded his station. These are indicated within Part 3 of each wizard's codex.

If a wizard loses his Pact-Fragment, he is unable to spend Time in these indicated ways.

Wizards may spend Time within other Domains, as long as that action doesn't require the associated Pact-Fragment. However, spending Time in another wizard's Domain may be considered a violation of **Pact-Law** in the event of its discovery (page XXXX).

Example of Play: The First Week of April

In the month of April in the 17th year of the Age of Knives...

["I'll increase my Depth by 1, lowering into the Near Gates," says Sara as the Necromancer.

"I'm spending my first week of Time on a holiday. It's Brother's Day, and I'm visiting Temple Ushin. I think I'm getting extremely drunk," says Aspen as the Hierophant.

"The Warlock, Sir Ignatius of Clan Waine, will spend his week pushing his own Clan Waine to fight against the Pirate Syndicates of Scuttleport," says Ridley.

"Move Storm north," says Carey as the Mariner.

"Okay I want to have my scene now. I have my Engagement Token on the Hierophant, so... where do you want to meet?" Asks Juniper as the Faustian.

"Oh. Well obviously it'll be at the big Saint Innocent's Day parade on Caravesse. Hesychast is going to be...not very sober."

"That'll make two of us!"]

Engagement Tokens

Despite the endless pressures placed upon the Pact, wizards still manage to carve some time from their lives to meet with their peers. In addition to their four Time tokens, each player has an **Engagement Token**. A wizard may schedule that Engagement (at the same Phase and in the same fashion as he schedules Time) with any other character. He spends that Engagement to have a scene with them (page XXXX).

Engagements are most often held between two wizards. In the tradition of the Pact, it is the duty of the wizard setting the Engagement to determine the time of day, and the duty of the wizard receiving the Engagement to determine the location. Wizards cannot refuse an Engagement with another wizard.

If a wizard schedules an Engagement with a Denizen (any character besides the wizards embodied by the players), the Celestial Audience chooses from amongst their ranks to represent the will of that Denizen. If the Denizen is actively avoiding the wizard's attention, the wizard must also schedule Time for the Engagement, or he may reschedule the Engagement to meet with someone else.

Flashbacks [box]

An Engagement may be used to set a scene in the past, depicting events which occurred earlier in the month, year, or even decades before the game began. The only limitations are that the wizard must still be present for the Engagement, and such a flashback cannot fundamentally change events which happened after it.

The Celestial Audience

Principles & Interventions

The Celestial Audience is composed of stations known as **Watchers**. Each player possesses their wizard's Watcher role, but over the course of play may choose to hand off or take on different roles. Part 4 of each wizard's codex covers more specific responsibilities of each Watcher role.

The shared **Principles** of the Celestial Audience:

- **Everything Has A Price.** Every victory is either hard fought for or more complicated than it initially seems. Even the most mundane actions produce complications beyond that which you originally anticipate. The game thrives from the challenges the Celestial Audience provides the Pact.
- **We Dream of Another World.** As we play, together we will imagine the inner workings of a fantastical other world, full of magic and mystery, long-forgotten secrets, and cultures unlike ours. We must stay honest to this world as we dream of it, reflect the truth of the people who live there, and discover together how it changes through our Wizards.
- **There Is Always More To Learn.** This game is composed of a tremendous quantity of written material, scattered across many different books. It also represents a living, twisting world, which at times may hew closely to our own. It is also composed of all the choices we've made. Ask leading questions, research its inner workings, and debate the operations of its text.

Additionally, each of the Watchers have their own set of Principles which they govern.

To express these Principles, along with the Principles of one's Watcher role, they may perform various Interventions, specific questions or changes to the gamestate based on the scene. In addition to the ones listed in each wizard's Codex, the following are also available:

- Describe an aspect of the world you find compelling.
- Ask leading questions (*such as "How did this happen?", "What are you hiding?" or "What do you do?"*)
- Remind the wizard of a previously-established obstacle.
- Establish an obstacle facing the wizard.
- Play as a Denizen (either new or previously established).
- Invoke rules or lore from any codex.

The Seven Watchers of the Celestial Audience

Each of the seven Watcher roles governs a different aspect of the narrative and mechanical reality of **Seven-Part Pact**. These are:

- **The Gate-Watcher**, who is responsible for the Rules for Dying and Funerary Rites and the nature of the Realms of Death and the afterlife. They guard the truth that *All Wizards Are Mortal*.
- **The Flame-Watcher**, who is responsible for the Rules for Companions, the common folk of Isha, and the religious practices of the populace. They guard the truth that *All Wizards Are Lonely*.
- **The Throne-Watcher**, who is responsible for the Rules for Combat and Warfare, the government of Isha, and the nature of masculine social pressure. They guard the truth that *All Wizards Are Men*.
- **The Storm-Watcher**, who is responsible for the Rules for Journeying, the wild places of the world, and the great beasts of faraway lands. They guard the truth that *All Wizards Are Mighty*.
- **The Chain-Watcher**, who is responsible for the Devil, the Rules for Antagonists, and the escalation of conflict and tension. They guard the truth that *Everything Has A Price*.
- **The Star-Watcher**, who is responsible for the Rules for Epilogues, Dream Journeys, and the possible future of the game. They guard the truth that *We Dream of Another World*.
- **The Truth-Watcher**, who is responsible for the Rules of the Pact, how to research the setting, and magic outside the Pact. They guard the truth that *There Is Always More To Learn*.

Divisions of Responsibility [box]

The Necromancer, Hierophant, Warlock, and Mariner are sometimes called in ancient texts the "Lower Four" Magi, for their associated Watcher roles govern the material world. The truths they safeguard are binding to the wizards of the Pact.

Meanwhile, the Faustian, Sage, and Sorcerer are conversely known as the "Upper Three" Magi, for their Watcher Roles relate to the state of the world more broadly, the ways characters relate to one another, and the governance of the Celestial Audience as a whole.

Taking On Another Watcher Role

When there's fewer than seven players at the table, or when one or more players are incapable of making detached choices about the events of play, they may hand off their associated Watcher

role to another player. That player is empowered to make choices and play Denizens on behalf of that Watcher role, combining both of their positions in the Celestial Audience together.

Impact

Most of the time, the three roles possessed by each player work upon each other in a particular order. The player manipulates the board game and mechanics of the Celestial Audience, the events and actions of the Celestial Audience manipulate the fictional world of the wizard. However, frequently (and especially through magic), the fictional events within Isha will be reinterpreted back onto the mechanics of the Celestial Audience. The process of interpreting fictional occurrences into mechanical changes is known as determining the occurrence's **Impact**.

Impact is divided into two categories: **Gifts** (referring to any generally positive or useful Impact) and **Complications** (referring to any generally negative or disruptive Impact). A non-exhaustive list of possible Gifts and Complications, sorted by Domain and intensity, can be found starting on page XXXX.

Impact will occur in any of the following situations:

- The rules of a Domain will call for the creation of a Gift or Complication. In this event, the Watcher associated with the rules will determine a suitably appropriate Impact.
- A fictional event, such as the actions of a character, organization, or landmass, will connect to one of the Domain boards. In this event, the Watcher who feels this Impact is appropriate will explain it to the Celestial Audience, and if no one disagrees, make the appropriate changes.
- A wizard casts a spell, following the rules of magic starting on page XXXX. In this event, the Celestial Audience will work with the wizard to determine the spell's Impact based on the description of the fictional effect of the spell.

The Celestial Audience is encouraged to be generous with its distribution of Complications, and stingy with its distribution of Gifts. [footnote: While Complications are stressful for wizards, they also produce more interesting dynamics within each Domain game, and ultimately enrich the game as a whole.]

Minor, Major, and Gamechanging Impact [box]

A **Minor** Impact can be produced by any individual given sufficient dedication and effort. Minor Gifts are often equivalent to what a wizard could accomplish with his Time, and Minor Complications are equivalently irritating.

A **Major** Impact cannot be done by mundane hands, and requires magical intervention or supernatural power. Major Gifts are often the equivalent of many weeks of Time, and Major Complications are disastrous for a wizard's Domain.

A **Gamechanging** Impact is extremely rare, a fundamental alteration to the structure of a wizard's Domain. They are produced through strenuous effort and tremendous magic. Gamechanging Impacts should be distributed extremely sparingly and only when undeniably demanded by the fiction. For more information on Gamechanging Impact, see page XXXX.

Scenes

Scenes serve as the core of roleplaying in **Seven-Part Pact**, the period in which great magic is performed, dramatic arguments break out between wizards, and the tumultuous nature of the world is revealed and focused upon. They serve as the highlights of a month, the exciting moments that provide opportunities to paint the dream of Isha in vibrant hues.

Playing Through Scenes

At the start of each scene, loosely establish the following key details:

- **Who** is present in this scene?
- **What** is each character doing during this scene?
- **When** and **Where** is this scene taking place?
- **Why** is this scene happening? What do the characters present want from it?

Based on **who** is present, each player determines what perspective they embody during the scene:

- **Is your wizard present?** If so, represent your wizard during the scene, and give your Watcher role to a member of the Celestial Audience.
- **Is a prominent Denizen within your Domain present?** (For instance, if the King of Isha is present for the Warlock.) If so, represent this character during the scene, and keep an eye out for your Watcher role in the Celestial Audience. If both are present, hand the Denizen to another Watcher to embody.
- **Otherwise**, act as part of the Celestial Audience, describing the environment of the scene, side characters present, and the outside world's reactions to the events occurring (page XXXX).

At the start of the scene, based on **where** and **who** is present, a player may (if they wish to) read out an appropriate portion of the lore in their Wizard's Codex contextualizing the scene. If the scene is set on the Wizard's isle, for instance, you may read out a sentence from your description of that isle.

Scenes can be as short as a vignette or a montage, highlighting a few key moments or a broad-strokes discussion of what may happen during it. Scenes can also be longer and more involved, featuring dramatic fights, passionate arguments, and many spells cast back and forth.

End the scene the moment it begins to run out of tension, or if the Wizard who called for it has reached a conclusion. At the end of the scene, the Celestial Audience can ask any clarifying questions about what happens next that they're interested in or that is relevant to their Domain. [footnote: Scenes contribute the most to the length of **Seven-Part Pact**. Shorter scenes will allow more months over the course of play, but longer scenes can frequently be more fulfilling. Discuss with your fellow players if you're concerned about scene length.]

Example of Play: Meeting on the Shore

In the 1st week of April in the 17th year of the Age of Knives, the Sage Osrion [played by Audrey] and the Sorcerer Halmyrion Twinstar [played by Ezra] met at the edge of the Moonlit Atoll.

["We meet at dusk." says Ezra as the Truth-Watcher, "and I'd like for us to get interrupted by someone else. I think it would be interesting."]

["The waves are warm here," says the Storm-Watcher, "and the birds are old. They remember ancient days when wizards met, and stay clear of you both."]

"We're not alone. I can feel it. There's someone else here..." Osrion, wise even beyond his years, murmured.

["Hey Throne-Watcher, which noble clan sent an ambassador to meet with us?" Asks Ezra. "Give me a sec, I've got a cool idea..." The Throne-Watcher replies.]

"You're right, old man. I figured it's good to keep an eye on your magic — especially since you still owe my family your end of the bargain." A masked man in the colors of Clan Ix emerged from the woods, accompanied by several soldiers.

Communication Tools

Seven-Part Pact involves conversation, and frequently multiple layers of conflicting conversation. Disagreements, misunderstandings, and outright conflict can arise between wizards, amongst the Celestial Audience, and above the table — and while sometimes these can provide a lot of pleasure, they can also create a lot of unenjoyable tension. Some groups of players are better equipped to handle this tension than others. While this text cannot teach you how to perfectly communicate with other people, some valuable tools players can use (both during play and outside of it) to assist in communication include:

- **Refer to the Palette.** Use the Palette as a reference point when framing and playing through scenes. If a risky topic appears in play, remind the Celestial Audience of the Palette and collectively discuss how to approach it. Just because something happened in the world of **Seven-Part Pact** doesn't mean the Celestial Audience needs to see it play out.
- **Address the role.** The wizard, the Watcher, and the player are all different people with different perspectives. When speaking about another player's wizard, make it clear that you're talking about their *wizard*, not them. If you have a question about rules or setting, address their Watcher role. If you want to check in with someone's emotions, address your fellow players by name.
- **Express perspective.** Stressful game events can occur during play, and it's possible to get swept up in the emotions of your Watcher or your wizard. If you find your emotions becoming tangled, lay them out clearly for the rest of the table: "*This is what I think. This is what my wizard thinks.*" Your emotions may still flare up due to someone's in-game actions, but it can help to draw a clear distinction between your wizard's grief and your personal irritation.

- **Extend grace.** Trust that all players seek to have an enjoyable and compelling experience together, even if you disagree about how to get there. Tell players when you disagree with them and receive their disagreements gracefully. Ask for the perspective of players who have contributed less than you. Explore the philosophies of others with curiosity.
- **Take breaks.** Remind the table to take pauses between months to drink water, eat food, and use the bathroom. If it seems like another player is losing energy, offer them a glass of water or suggest pausing to eat food. Proactively step away when you need to and return when you're ready.
- **Use other communication tools.** Players from a shared culture may already have tools for negotiating conflict. Tools like the X-Card or Lines & Veils are popular in many RPG communities. Cultural frameworks around productive disagreement, such as *machloket l'shem shamayim*, can aid players from shared backgrounds. Bring whatever tools are most effective and find methods to enable each other to share your perspectives.

Being The Celestial Audience

When you take part in the Celestial Audience, you are not necessarily playing as any particular character. You instead compose one portion of a heavenly viewpoint, collectively sculpting the firmament of the world for the wizards of the Pact to act upon. When acting as the Celestial Audience broadly, some useful advice is:

- **Make strong choices about the world.** Describe the world and how it operates. Ensure the wizards feel like they're part of a broader setting. Think about the beauty of the landscape, the cruelty of men, the grandeur of magic.
- **Explore the hidden cost of various acts.** Bring up ramifications the other wizards might not have considered. Ask lots of questions about everything that interests you. Connect dots together. Transform the sea of possibility into a single coherent whole.
- **Interpret the text of the game.** Rules, setting, advice, and logic intertwine. Work together to interpret what happens as wizards cast spells, take game actions, and modify their world. Be opinionated on your interpretations and justify your stance to others.

Playing To Struggle [box]

When you play as the Celestial Audience, your goals are different from those of your wizard. While your wizard may be ruthless in his pursuit of his desires, the Celestial

Audience is the force which stands in his way, and when you're part of the Celestial Audience, you must be no less ruthless in your solidity. The world only feels as real as the Celestial Audience insists it is, and to create a compelling struggle, the Celestial Audience must be inflexible in its insistence on the operations of the world. As Celestial Audience, you may end up making choices which directly negatively impact your wizard. Remain faithful to your understanding of the world, even if that understanding punishes your wizard. He'll thank you for it later.

Being A Denizen

Whenever you play as any character besides your wizard, you are playing as a Denizen. A Denizen is anyone (or, frequently, any group of people) who aren't one of the player's wizards. Denizens vary tremendously: in might, in philosophy, in desire, and in perspective. Sometimes the same Denizen might be played by multiple wizards across multiple scenes, depending on the needs of that scene. Regardless of who you're playing, some useful advice is:

- **Know what you want from a scene.** Every time any Denizen is in a scene, they're trying to get *something*. It might be related to a broader ambition or scheme (such as wealth, security, or fame) or it might be extremely immediate (such as safety or reassurance). If a Denizen is in a scene against their wishes, maybe they just want to get away. If you don't know what a Denizen wants from a scene, use the time spent in the scene to learn what they want.
- **Contribute to what came before you.** Do your best to respect and build upon what's already been established by the other Watchers and by the rules of the game, but also contribute your own perspective and twist on the Denizen. Multiple Watchers may each play the same character in wildly different ways, but as long as you're all drawing on what has come before you, the Denizen will feel cohesive. If necessary, step away from the scene and ask the Celestial Audience questions about the character to help ground their choices.
- **Hint at a bigger picture.** Denizens have lives outside the wizards of the Pact (and if they don't, they wish they did). Show glimpses into that life when you have the opportunity. Make strong choices about the secret internality of the Denizen, an internality the Celestial Audience might not otherwise have a window into. Express your Denizen's perspective and philosophy of the world, even as it differs from the perspective of the Pact.

Protagonists without a Viewpoint [box]

Occasionally Denizens will appear who are just as captivating, if not moreso, than the wizards of the Pact. Companions with narrative arcs of their own, heroes on quests who briefly intersect with the Pact, a demon with a heartbreaking backstory, or other engaging storylines emerging from the chaos of the Orrery. These are beautiful characters, but the Celestial Audience cannot stare directly at them. The limited framework of Time and Engagements means you can only ever see the narratives of these Denizens obliquely, hidden in the margins of the great men that you are fixated on. These special Denizens are no less vulnerable than any others; their lives no less caught in the capacious whims of the Pact. These Denizens can only ever be understood through their relationships with your wizard, but frequently that longing for more is a beautiful and compelling moment in and of itself.

Being Your Wizard

Wizards are the central framing for every scene. Every scene has at least one wizard present, and that wizard is frequently the one setting the scene for others. When playing as your wizard in a scene, you should strive to remember:

- **Cut to the chase.** Express your wizard's desires from the scene as quickly as possible. If he's here to enjoy the company of his wife, do so. If he's here to threaten an enemy, do so. If he's here to kill someone, skip the niceties. If it wouldn't be appropriate for your wizard to act in this way, speak with the Celestial Audience and decide whether to skip forward or reframe the scene.
- **You can't do it wrong.** Your wizard is the sum of the creative choices you've made up until this moment — but like all people, he is mutable to his circumstances. Perhaps he's been a bastard up until this moment, but in this scene he's had a change of heart. Every choice you make with your wizard is the right one to make. Make strong choices and commit to them.

A wizard can freely use and invoke his Humble Magic, his Treasures, and any objects he has on his person during any scene. He may also cast magic during scenes by following the rules on page XXXX.

The Wizardmoot

The Wizardmoot is a special scene which occurs at the end of each month, featuring all wizards who scheduled Time on the Meeting Phase. It is set at midnight upon the Isle of the Orrery, or in a location of the Archmagus's choice (if the Orrery is inaccessible for any reason). It is a conversation moderated by the Archmagus, serving as a period during which wizards can inform each other of the events of their Domain, coordinate their intentions for future months, and demonstrate their superiority over each other. [footnote: If the Archmagus fails to attend the Wizardmoot, the eldest wizard present takes on the temporary title "Secretary of the Pact" and acts in the Archmagus's stead.]

The Celestial Audience (or the Archmagus) sets the scene by describing the Orrery and the way the weather has changed the isle. They then ask: *"As each wizard arrives, he announces: 'I stand before the Pact.' Describe your entrance. Who is early? Who is late?"*

Once all wizards have introduced themselves before the Moot, the Archmagus announces: *"Beneath the bloodless night we sit, the Pact eternal before the stars. Tell me brother, how fares your Domain?"* He asks each wizard this question in turn, giving them space to answer, before other matters are brought before the Pact.

As each wizard leaves the Wizardmoot, his player retrieves his Time from the Meeting Phase.

Summary of the Phases [box]

The New Moon Phase:

1. Move each Planet clockwise an amount equal to its Arc.
2. Move the Sun forward one month.

The Visions Phase:

1. Each wizard modifies their Domain according to Part 3 in their Codex, then Watches the Stars.
 - a. The Necromancer moves all Foes forward, then moves all Souls deeper into death.
 - b. The Hierophant adjusts each Supplicant based on their need.
 - c. The Warlock assigns Fiat, Wealth, and Might according to Titles.
 - d. The Mariner moves each Storm according to the dominant wind.
 - e. The Faustian places a Scheme on each Pawn (and two on each Conspiracy).
 - f. The Sage removes an appropriate number of Omens from the Pact's Future.

- g. The Sorcerer gains Knowledge according to the placement of his Researchers, then performs the operations of his Students, Professors, Librarians, and Alchemists.
2. Any Impacts generated by wizards on other Domains are applied.

The Planning Phase:

1. Each wizard schedules four weeks of Time in any combination of valid places:
 - a. On one of his Companions to benefit from their care. When he spends that Time, he gains +1 in the associated Element for the duration of the month.
 - b. On his Map to explore, caretake, and maintain his home. When he spends that Time, he reveals something new on the Map and/or changes the lore of his isle or sanctum.
 - c. On his Familiar to prepare his magic. When he spends that Time, he Patiently Casts a Spell (page XXXX).
 - d. On the Orrery to travel there and manipulate its inner workings. When he spends that Time, he adjusts the position of any planet forward or backwards a distance equal to its Arc.
 - e. On the Meeting Phase. All wizards who schedule Time in this fashion attend the Wizardmoot (page XXXX) during the Meeting Phase.
 - f. On a multitude of different portions within his Domain, according to the rules of that Domain (Part 3 of the relevant codex).
2. Each wizard also schedules an Engagement on any other character to have a scene with them:
 - a. If the wizard wishes to have a scene alone, he may schedule that Engagement on himself or on his Familiar.
 - b. If the character doesn't want to have a scene with the wizard, the wizard must also schedule a week of Time.

The Story Phase:

1. Proceeding around the table, each wizard removes either one week of Time or his Engagement and either performs the associated mechanical effect or roleplays the scene.
2. This continues until the only weeks remaining are scheduled for the Wizardmoot.

The Meeting Phase:

1. Each wizard who scheduled Time on the Wizardmoot attends a shared scene at the Orrery.
 - a. If the Orrery is inaccessible, the current Archmagus declares where the Wizardmoot will occur.

The Quiet Phase:

1. Certain changes are made by certain wizards:

- a. The Warlock resolves the events of the Debutante Ball during the Quiet Phases of March, June, September, and December.
 - b. The Faustian resolves any face-down Schemes.
 - c. The Sorcerer resolves any Reliable Arcanists.
2. All players take a quick break for water and snacks, if they haven't already.

Magic

The world is a complicated machine in its infinite array, countless fractal pieces interlocking into great whirring institutions, droplets of rain building up into storms which grow the crops and govern the lives of man. All that lies beneath the heavens is part of this machine, and it all may be broken in an instant through the use of magic.

Magic is the tool Wizards use to fundamentally break the game's rules. Nearly anything is possible, as long as the Wizard can find the appropriate spell, justify its Impact fictionally, and he is willing to risk the Complications which may ensue. All of magic known to the Pact is recorded within *The Grimoire*, a tome composed of countless miraculous acts. Each wizard has his own copy of *The Grimoire*, with the master copy maintained by the Sorcerer within his Tower upon Spyrholm.

Casting magic is divided into three stages: **Articulation**, **Initiation**, and **Incantation**. During the Articulation stage, the player finds the spell their wizard wishes to cast and reviews its **Limits**, articulating it to the Celestial Audience. During the Initiation stage, the player determines how many dice they roll and what the Glyphs produced will mean, should their wizard commit to the spell. During the Incantation stage, the spell takes effect upon the world, and the Celestial Audience makes changes to **Seven-Part Pact** determined by the fictional contents of the spell.

While a wizard may draw upon his treasures and humble magics at any moment, he can only cast a true spell from *The Grimoire* under two circumstances:

- During any scene the wizard is present for.
- By spending Time to cast the spell **Patiently**, if the spell permits it. [footnote: See page XXXX.]

Articulation

The first stage of Spellcasting is **Articulation**, in which the wizard identifies within *The Grimoire* the precise Spell he seeks to cast. During this stage he discusses the **limits** of the spell with the Celestial Audience, to determine if his use of this magic would defy any limits. He then identifies at what **Import** and through which **Element** he performs his magic. This will determine how many Dice and of what kind he uses, and if he has access to any additional Dice.

Finding The Correct Spell

There are more than fifty Spells contained within the *Grimoire*, ranging from the situationally useful to the consistently relevant, from the rare and powerful to the mundane and unremarkable. Wizards know every single one of these spells, all of them crowding together to take up room in his mind and begging to be cast. Searching through *The Grimoire* to identify the correct Spell to cast is itself part of the challenge of magic, and a wizard's skill is often measured by his creativity in the heat of conflict.

Wizards are encouraged to be mindful of their ability to recall spells in the heat of the moment, to research the Spells one may wish to cast well in advance, and to study *The Grimoire* and familiarize himself with its materials when he has time to do so. *The Grimoire* is divided into eight Schools, each of which cover a different form of magic, which may aid him in his search:

- **Enchantment:** The Study of Breathing Life
- **Metamorphosis:** The Study of True Transformation
- **Oneirism:** The Study of Manipulating Dreams
- **Divination:** The Study of the Future and the Past
- **Thaumaturgy:** The Study of the Old Laws
- **Invocation:** The Study of the Secret Names
- **Artifice:** The Study of Miraculous Creation

The Ogdoad [box]

Within each School is one of the Ogdoad, one of the eight great works of magic which demonstrates a wizard's mastery over this School. The Ogdoad are both especially powerful and especially dangerous. Some involve many months of preparation and

incantation to perform, while others can be cast in an instant. They are the greatest demonstration of the necessity of a wizard's thoughtfulness and reflection.

The Limits of Magic

Each spell is accompanied by a set of limits, restrictions upon the scope and ability of the magic which if dismissed will cause the spell to act out of turn. If a spell's limits are violated, it will result in a specific Consequence, which varies dramatically according to the Spell. A wizard may knowingly and intentionally violate these limits if he is willing to accept the consequences.

A Spell's Import

The Import of a spell determines the scope and intensity at which the wizard casts it. There are four Imports, each one corresponding to differently-sized dice. The greater the Import, the larger the dice, and the more uncertainty and variety the wizard introduces into the spell. [footnote: For some spells, the Import sets the minimum necessary — for instance, you can choose to cast Mimesis at Mighty Import, even if only Arcane Import is required. For other spells, the Import sets the maximum possible — for instance, you must meet the requirements of Mythic Import in order to cast Hex at that scale.]

Import	Dice	Nature
Personal	D6	<i>For spells that influence the personal lives of humans, or are subtle in their machinations.</i>
Arcane	D8	<i>For spells which enter into other realms or powerful forces of the world, and yet confident and secure.</i>
Mighty	D10	<i>For spells which challenge death or grapple with great forces beyond a magician's control.</i>
Mythic	D12	<i>For spells which go beyond the wildest extent thought possible.</i>

The Four Elements

A Wizard contains within himself the four Elements as humors, balanced within his body by his temperament and personality. The Elements are both literal and metaphorical, and exactly what they represent within each spell will vary tremendously. The Wizard chooses which of the four

Elements is most appropriate for the spell based on their description. He will roll a number of dice equal to the appropriate Element, of a size equal to the chosen Import.

Even if a Wizard lacks a particular Element entirely, he may still perform magic using this Element. He rolls a single die, and regardless of the results of the dice, he must proceed straight from Initiation to Incantation, forfeiting his *Rite of Refusal*. [footnote: See page XXXX. The Wizard forfeits his Rite of Refusal even if he obtains more Dice through Spellcasting.]

Additional Dice [box]

A Wizard may be able to access additional Dice, either through the use of certain Treasures or through the Spell's own rules. These Dice are at the same Import as the spell itself unless otherwise specified.

Casting Magic Patiently

Many spells may be cast Patiently through a series of rituals or acts of physical preparation. Patient spellcasting done in this fashion allows the Wizard to prepare and perform magic outside of high-pressure situations. In order to cast a spell Patiently, the Wizard spends Time performing its associated rituals. [footnote: Wizards are encouraged to determine their Glyphs and note down his interpretation of his magic whilst other Wizards resolve their weeks of time.]

A spell may only be cast Patiently if it specifies how to do so within its description.

When a wizard casts a spell Patiently, after seeing the results of his dice, he may choose to reroll all dice and decide which set he prefers more. If a Wizard invokes his *Rite of Refusal* after viewing both sets of results, the Spell has failed, and the Time has been wasted.

Knowledge of the Secret Names

Many spells depend upon the knowledge and recitation of the *secret names* of various beasts, plants, geographic features, and demons. A secret name is not the word used within the common tongue, or any tongue still spoken upon this world, but is instead the name given to such a being by the wizards of ancient days before the Tragedies, when those great magi worked to taxonomize all of creation within their wisdom.

It is safe to assume any wizard of proper training would be familiar with (or capable of quickly recalling) the secret names of any animals, geographic formations, or plants which are found upon or adjacent to his Isle and Sanctum. A wizard may determine the secret name of any force or being which exists upon or within the Faraway Sea by spending Time upon the relevant Map, or by casting the spell Patiently. The secret names of demons, fairies, and other powerful beings requires research at the furthest and most secret academies, and will require aid from the Truth-Watcher.

Each wizard has four secret names, each known by one of his different Companions, and each known only to the wizard and their associated Companion.

Initiation

The next stage of Spellcasting is **Initiation**, in which the wizard rolls his spell's dice and sees what Glyphs are at his disposal. Each Glyph corresponds to a different outcome of his magic, and he must make use of all of them. It is during this period the wizard may use his Pact-Fragment, or any other resources at his disposal, to adjust the dice. The Wizard discusses with the Celestial Audience what the outcome of his magic would result in, and if this sits easy with him he may proceed.

Meaning of each Glyph

When rolling the dice, the result of each number corresponds with a single Glyph — an astrological symbol which contains some arcane property. Each spell has specific rules for interpreting each Glyph, but across spells there are consistent patterns in meaning. [footnote: The number of each Glyph is included for those using numbered polyhedral dice.]

Glyph	Number	Meaning
☉	1	Salt , which a Wizard replaces with his own Glyph through his Pact-Fragment.
♃	2, 3, 4	Jupiter , matters of daily life, family, and the home.
♂	5	Mars , matters of conflict, war, and masculinity.
♀	6	Venus , matters of nature, desire, and femininity.

Glyph	Number	Meaning
	7	Mercury , matters of transformation, travel, and deceit.
	8	Luna , matters of intellectualism, wisdom, and secrecy.
	9	Saturn , matters of death, rot, and the underworld.
	10	Neptune , matters of dreams, visions, and the sublime unknowable.
	11	Sol , matters of light, imperial rule, and power.
	12	Sulfur , where the spell acts treacherously against you.

Interpretation

The wizard and the Celestial Audience work together to determine what the Spell will do to the Faraway Sea and the world of the Seven-Part Pact. This Interpretation occurs both fictionally (identifying what narrative changes will occur as a result of the magic) and mechanically (identifying how each wizard's Domain may be Impacted as a result of the magic). Certain members of the Celestial Audience, such as the Chain-Watcher, may seek to intentionally point out ways the world may suffer as a result of the magic. The Truth-Watcher is the moderator and key interpreter — default to their judgment above all else.

The Wizard is able to know the full Interpretation of the Spell, and invoke the Rite of Refusal, before he performs the Incantation.

The Rite of Refusal [box]

One of the skills which positions a wizard as separate and above all other practitioners of magic is his ability to determine what Glyphs are available to him and in that moment choose to reject the spell, tossing aside the dice and choosing not to cast this magic. If a Wizard rejects a spell in such a fashion, he cannot attempt to cast it again for the remainder of the month.

A Wizard forfeits the Rite of Refusal if he has 0 in the Spell's associated Elemental Circle.

Incantation

The final stage of Spellcasting is **Incantation**, in which the Wizard casts the spell, inflicting his will upon the world and changing the very framework of reality, facing the Impact of this magic in the process.

Fictional Effect

Magic can do anything if the Celestial Audience can implement it, and the wizard can justify it through the fictional results of the spell itself. Through magic, the impossible can be performed, the unstoppable may be prevented, and the undefeatable may be overcome.

It's equally as important to remember that if a Glyph *wasn't* rolled, its effect cannot occur. Sometimes when determining the fictional effect of a spell, it's useful to go through the Glyphs left aside to see what definitively *cannot* happen.

Once the fictional effect is determined, the Celestial Audience then determines the mechanical Impact, following the rules on page XXXX and drawing on the List of Gifts & Complications on page XXXX. Generally, any spell will provide at least one Gift and at least one Complication.

Lacunae

A Lacuna is a gap in the Grimoire, an area of magic which ancient wizards were once capable of performing, but which the Pact in its current form is no longer capable of accomplishing. Any spell currently within the Grimoire cannot, under any circumstances, produce an Impact which would accomplish one of the Lacunae, unless that spell is specifically listed as an exception.

The following Lacunae are apparent from *The Grimoire*:

- **The Law of Death.** No spell within the Grimoire can bring someone dead to life *exactly* as they were before. If someone returns from death, they will always carry a sign of their experience.
- **The Law of Man.** No spell within the Grimoire, save *Anthropogenesis*, can create a new soul from truly nothing. Spells which provide a soul do so through the imitation and duplication of another's (most frequently the Wizard's own).

- **The Law of Travel.** No spell within the Grimoire possesses the ability to move any being forward or backwards in time, nor may any spell known be used to instantaneously move from one location to another.
- **The Law of Stars.** No spell within the Grimoire possesses the ability to be cast upon the stars in the sky, the Sun, the Moon, or any other Celestial Body, nor is it possible for any Spell to reach the Celestial Bodies.
- **The Law of Destiny.** No spell within the Grimoire can force a precise event to come to pass (although spells may shape how the future does itself come to pass).

Wards Against Malediction

Any spell cast directly upon a wizard, or any object or person making direct physical contact with a wizard, is considered a potential **Malediction**, an affront upon the wizard. Magical beings are guarded by **Wards** against aggressive spells such as these. A wizard's Wards are each equal to 1 plus his Element, and he has four Wards, one for each Element. When a Malediction is cast upon a wizard, his Wards against this magic stir to life, and for each Ward he possesses in that spell's Element, he negates one Glyph of his choice from the spell cast upon him.

If a magical weapon or Treasure strikes a wizard, or is placed onto a wizard without his consent, his Wards will similarly guard him against some portion of the weapon's capacity.

Wards are instinctual and automatic, active even while a wizard slumbers. A wizard may choose to permit magic to be cast upon him if he chooses.

The only method by which one may circumvent a being's Wards is through the speaking of one of their secret names (see page XXXX). The surprise of hearing one's own secret name is enough to, for an instant, prompt that being to lower their Wards and open their heart. Once a true name has been used in this fashion, it cannot be used again.

Treasures and Lingering Magic

Magic always leaves behind reminders of its presence. It is the shared responsibility of the Celestial Audience to track and maintain this presence by recording the associated Glyphs of any spell whose presence lasts beyond the scene it's in on a card. Should that card ever be misplaced, the spell has been forgotten, and the magic loses its power over the world. The most common kind of lingering magic are Treasures.

Treasures are magical artifacts produced most frequently through incantations of *Artifice*. They can range from a pocket trinket to an entire mansion, from a flying cap to the god-killing sword. Treasures are recorded on cards, and each incantation is the process by which a wizard develops his Treasure further. When the spell is cast, he writes down all Glyphs produced through this magic, the associated Element, and the resulting qualities granted to the Treasure, on that Treasure's card. Treasures can always be iterated upon and improved further through the use of further spells.

Lingering magic can produce consistent Impacts on the Domains of various wizards.

When a wizard creates his own treasures, they are each recorded on their own piece of paper. If the player is to misplace this paper, the treasure has been correspondingly lost. These treasures have a number of truths to them, and may be relied on to an even greater degree, for they emerge from a Wizard's own creation.

A wizard's Domain may offer the chance to acquire further treasures. A wizard may, upon traveling to his Domain, argue to possess some object found in this place. For instance, the Warlock may grab the ancient sacred blade of Clan Waine from the catacombs beneath the Keep, or the Necromancer may return from the furthest gates of death in possession of Forgetting Fruit. The properties of these treasures are for you to decide. Work with the Wizard to create a new Treasure to represent these, and mark them down on a card.

Spells With Masters [box]

Certain spells reference possessing a Master. If the spell is a Treasure, its Master is the current possessor of the Treasure, and the spell's Master changes whenever someone obtains possession of the Treasure. If the spell isn't a Treasure, the spell's Master is the creator of the Spell, and that spell's Master may transfer this Mastery to any other willing being through any method deemed appropriate. Should the Master of a spell die, the spell itself will either crumble into mist or seek out a new Master.

Materials for Treasures

The great wheel of the world turns, not by the hand of any one man, but by the movement of coin and fur. Commerce is the method by which the strange and beautiful artifacts necessary for the most arcane and unfamiliar acts of spellcraft may be obtained, but even commerce has its

limits. To acquire an object requires careful precision and dedicated operation, and occasional travel to some of the furthest reaches of the Faraway Sea.

Materials are divided into four categories, based on how difficult they are to obtain:

- **Common** materials can be found anywhere in Isha. These include wicker, clay, paper, or other raw goods. A wizard doesn't even need to spend Time obtaining them unless the Celestial Audience believes him to be firmly and irreconcilably without it. [footnote: For example, if the Necromancer explicitly burnt down every tree on the Graven Isle, the Celestial Audience may force him to spend Time getting wood if he needs it to cast a spell.]
- **Uncommon** materials can be obtained at any Market in Isha. These include professionally-forged weapons, jewelry, or alchemical reagents. A wizard may possess some of these materials in his Sanctum, or he may need to spend Time at a Market to obtain them, based on the stance of the Celestial Audience.
- **Rare** materials can only be obtained outside Isha, or at a Market with a Rarity. [footnote: See *The Book of Storms* for more information on Markets with Rarities.] These include exotic materials, expertly-constructed weapons, or magical Treasures. A wizard must embark on a Journey to obtain such an object, or they must spend Time at a Market with a Rarity.
- **Monstrous** materials are the most valuable of all objects, which can only be obtained from slaying a Beast. If there is no appropriate Beast in Isha, the wizard must embark on a Journey to find one.

The Import of a Treasure is often determined by the rarity of the materials composing its structure.

Examples of Magic In Play

The Hand of the King

In the 3rd week of May in the 17th year of the Age of Knives, the Warlock Sir Ignatius Waine [Watcher of the Throne and played by Ridley] deemed it apt to demonstrate to a doubting king the power of magic. [Ridley places an Engagement token on the King and has a scene with him and his court] He did so by casting **Hand of Power**. [page XXXX of the *Grimoire*.] Sir Ignatius Waine observed and followed its Limits of Observation, Duration, and Sympathy. He

determined the hand would be as large as himself, but no larger, which therefore meant the spell was of **Arcane Import**. [Ridley goes for the eight-sided dice, or d8s.] The hand was made from the flames of the candles filling the Palace Throneroom, and therefore the spell was cast with **Fire**. [His Fire is 3, and so Ridley rolls three d8s.] He began his incantation with a great wave of his right hand, and the smell of unfamiliar reagents filled the room.

[Ridley rolls ♃ (*Jupiter*), ☿ (*Mercury*), and ☾ (*Salt*). The final Glyph is changed through the Warlock's Pact-Fragment into ♂ (*Mars*). Ridley reviews the meaning of these Glyphs and decides to proceed with the spell. "The hand is fully integrated into my Warlock's hand. It's capable of violence and it's incredibly fast." Ridley tells the table. The Truth-Watcher reminds them, "but it's not very subtle and you can't cast magic through it." "Yeah but I don't care about any of that. This will do."] Sir Ignatius Wayne lifted his right hand, and all the flame of the candles in the Palace lifted up with him. moving just as fast as his own hand, spreading up into the air. With a flick of his wrist the hand cascaded across the room, just barely missing the courtier's heads before dissolving into black smoke.

"Such is the power of my magic, oh king! And if I can do this so easily, imagine what we could do together." Sir Ignatius Wayne declared to the throne and all its subjects. ["I think that's enough to cause the King to change his Agenda from anti-magic to maybe something a bit more ... expansionist." Ridley tells the table, and the other players nod. The Flame-Watcher says, "Perhaps it also serves to rejuvenate some of the nobles' faith in magic?" The other players nod, and the Flame-Watcher moves the Gentry from the Courtyard to the Agiary. Then the Chain-Watcher speaks up, "I would like to shuffle another Agenda into the King's Clan's Deck, as he dreams of magic for his own ends..." Ridley nods their head, and the Chain-Watcher gives the King's Clan an *Ergoism* Agenda as a Complication.]

The Quest for the Stolen Bird

In the 2nd week of August in the 17th year of the Age of Knives, the Sage Orsion of Many Colors [Watcher of the Stars and played by Audrey] was about to die. The demon Zarimakht swung its misery-forged blade towards the Sage's head, and the entire world held its breath. [The Gate-Watcher spoke, "I think you have about two seconds to live. I think the only way you can survive this is if you completely debase yourself to the demon, and even still you may be miserably injured." "Screw that!" said Audrey, "I'm gonna cast a spell. The Demon's Wards will block anything offensive, but..."]

Orsion recalled his younger days, practicing metamorphosis with the fairies. He steadied his hands and cast *Murmuration* upon himself. [page XXXX of the *Grimoire*.] He respected the Limits of Contact, Daybreak, Equivalence, and Coalescence. He determined the spell was of **Personal Import** and, as he intended to transform into a flock of birds, was cast with **Air**. [Audrey takes 1 d6 and rolled it. She rolled ♀ (*Venus*). "Hmm, so I can communicate with others, but..." "Because you didn't get Jupiter, they're not capable of obeying your commands. The Demon is absolutely going to grab some of them." The Chain-Watcher says.]

["I could just invoke my Rite of Refusal here and try something else, right?" "You don't have enough time to try something else, I'm sorry. Your head is gonna be on the far side of Spyrhoim in half a second." Replies the Gate-Watcher.]

Orsion accepted what would come next. He transformed himself into a flock of blackbirds, each with a distinctive blue belly. They flew immediately in all directions, confounding the demon and leaving his sword to bounce uselessly off the wall. The birds scattered across the archipelago, soaring in all directions. The demon grabbed one of the birds out of the air, trapping it in the iron cage in its gullet.

["Sorry Audrey, I couldn't resist. That means you can't coalesce until you can get that last bird back." The Chain-Watcher says. "Don't worry, I'm the Sage. I have a backup plan."]

Several days later, Orsion's Prentice, a boy named Tallahan, was tending his garden when several blue-bellied blackbirds landed in front of him. In a shared and miserable squawk, they spoke as one.

"My student, I have a quest for you."

["Woah. So what does this mean for your domain?" Asks the Truth-Watcher. "That's a really good question," Audrey replies, "Can we take a break and figure that out together?"]

The Helpful Gnome

In the 1st week of July in the 17th year of the Age of Knives, the Hierophant Hesychast [Watcher of the Flames and played by Aspen] continued work on the Gnome-house he's been building from a **Canopic Vessel**. [page XXXX of the *Grimoire*.] This was a **Treasure**, an old ironwrought lamp well-made and enchanted at **Arcane Import**. Hesychast had been working on this Vessel for the past two months as well, and it was already heavy with magic. [Its Treasure

Card is marked with ♃ (*Jupiter*), ♂ (*Mars*), ♀ (*Venus*).] He spent the week working deep within the firmaments of the lamp, adjusting and tinkering with the balance of magic until he was certain the gnome who would come to dwell in it would find it pleasing. [Aspen rolls and gets ♀ (*Venus*), ♂ (*Mars*). Because he's casting Patiently, he rolls again and gets ♃ (*Jupiter*), ♀ (*Venus*). He prefers the second result.]

At the end of the seventh day, Hesychast rejoiced, for a small man came doddering out of the Vessel, eager to serve. ["According to this, his personality quirk is that he's "Diligent" and "Melancholic," and apparently he's "working on a novel." says the Star-Watcher, taking the place of the Flame-Watcher. Aspen laughs, "I think I'll name him Edgar."] Hesychast laughed as well, but for different reasons. "Finally my great plan! Oh little gnome, I command you to travel to each of the Temples each month, retrieve their offerings, and bring them back to Sacred Tahv."

["Okay, so my idea is that during the Visions Phase of each month, I'll take -1 Wealth to each non-Hestar Temple and place it on Hestar. I know that's not any particular Impact in the book, but it makes sense to me. Is that okay?" Aspen asks the group. "I don't think the little gnome can handle going everywhere every month. Could it be two Temples of your choice instead?" The Truth-Watcher replies. "Sure. Still saves me a boatload of Time each month either way. I'm surprised no one's ever tried this before!"]

["Yeah, I'm sure this will only go well for you." Says the Chain-Watcher with an evil glint in her eye.]

Summary of Magic [box]

Articulation:

1. Identify the spell your wizard intends to cast.
2. Review the spell's Limits and confirm you are following them. If you're not following the spell's Limits, review the resulting Consequence and discuss it with the Celestial Audience.
3. Identify the intended Import of the Spell.
 - a. Personal Import uses 6-sided dice.
 - b. Arcane Import uses 8-sided dice.
 - c. Mighty Import uses 10-sided dice.
 - d. Mythic Import uses 12-sided dice.

4. Identify the intended Element of the Spell.
 - a. The Element of a spell determines the quantity of dice rolled.
5. Gain additional dice from any Pact-Fragments or special abilities.
 - a. The Warlock's Pact-Fragment grants him +1 dice if he's casting a malediction.
 - b. The Mariner's Pact-Fragment grants him +1 dice if he's the only wizard present.
 - c. The Sorcerer's Pact-Fragment allows him to roll the Solar Die.

Initiation:

1. Roll the relevant dice.
2. Modify Glyphs according to Pact-Fragments and special abilities:
 - a. $\ominus$ (*Salt*) is used by each wizard to produce his associated Glyph.
 - b. The Necromancer may turn any number of Glyphs into ♄ (*Saturn*).
 - c. The Hierophant may turn two ♃ (*Jupiter*) Glyphs into any other Glyph (*with the exceptions of* ☉ *"Sol" or* ♁ *"Sulfur"*).
 - d. The Faustian may reroll. If he does, he also possesses an additional ♁ *"Sulfur"* Glyph.
 - e. If the Sage is present, he may change the result of any die to any other Glyph the die could have rolled.
 - f. If the spell is cast Patiently, you may reroll your dice and choose which result you prefer.
3. Look up each Glyph in the spell's rules and use this to determine the spell's effects. Discuss with the Celestial Audience.
4. After determining the effects of the spell, you may use the Rite of Refusal to decide not to cast the spell.

Incantation:

1. Determine the Impact of the Spell on other wizards' Domains.
2. If the Subject of the magic has Wards, they may negate one Glyph for each Ward.
3. If the spell creates a Treasure or other lingering magic, record it on a spare index card.

Continuing Play

As play continues, your group's campaign of **Seven-Part Pact** will venture deeper and deeper into unknown new territories, discovering truths not recorded or envisioned with this (or perhaps

any other) rulebook. This Part of the Rulebook covers beings, events, and experiences which might come up over the course of a longer campaign.

Silent, Absent, & New Wizards

It is common throughout the history of the Pact that one or more of its number are not Present. This may occur because a player has missed a session, a wizard has died or fled Isha, or there are fewer players than there are wizards in the Pact. A Silent wizard is one who steadily maintains his Domain but refuses contact with the outside world. An Absent wizard is actively not maintaining his Domain.

Silent Wizards

If a wizard is Silent, ignore his Domain. Assume he is in complete control over his responsibilities. If he ever appears in a scene, avoid roleplaying as him — let him loom quietly and monstrously. If one must roleplay as a Silent wizard, it is handled by the player with the wizard's associated Watcher role. If a Silent wizard would ever suffer a Complication, redirect that Complication onto any other wizard.

Absent Wizards

If a wizard is Absent, then he has forsaken his Domain and there is no one to take charge. If the wizard has been absent since the start of play, refer to the Age to see how to implement his lack. If a wizard was Present and suddenly becomes Absent (from death, abdication, or some other abrupt exile of play), continue adjusting his Domain according to how he Watches the Stars.

Welcoming New Wizards

When a new wizard is welcomed to **Seven-Part Pact** (either because someone's old wizard died or otherwise left, or because a new player has joined the game), they are abruptly thrust into a new set of responsibilities they may be unprepared for.

First, determine where your new wizard has come from. Perhaps he was a Denizen who was already active in the game, or the old wizard's Prentice, or he's an entirely new character dragged into the game.

Then, choose which wizard of the Pact is your new wizard's **Mentor**. Work with them to create your new wizard, answering the questions in Parts I and II of your wizard's Codex.

Then, review your wizard's Domain. If it's a Domain that's already been in play, it will already be prepared for your involvement. If it's a new Domain, set it up in any Arrangement.

Manipulative Mentors [box]

If a wizard was deposed by another wizard, the murderous wizard acts as Mentor for the betrayed wizard's replacement. As they're the one installing the new wizard, they're also the one influencing that wizard's perspective. The new wizard is encouraged to conform to his Mentor's vision, at least during the process of creating their wizard. Once they enter play, they can of course openly defy their Mentor.

Change Over Time

Over the course of play, time will pass, and the world will change. As the Celestial Audience of the Seven-Part Pact, you'll feel called to make these adjustments as your campaign continues. At periodic intervals, it will be good to take a break between seasons and discuss how the Pact as a whole has changed. These intervals are recommended during the Quiet Phase of each season (March, June, September, and December). Once a full year of play has passed, instead perform the Changing of Years.

Changing of Seasons

Going around the table, each player chooses 1:

- My Isle or Sanctum have changed with the season. *Add or Change the Lore of your Isle or Sanctum to reflect this. Adjust the Map appropriately.*
- My wizard has earned a new title in his exploits. *Ask the Celestial Audience to give your wizard a Title.*
- My wizard has been changed irrevocably by the magic he practices. *Ask the Celestial Audience to give your wizard a new Change of Magic.*
- I think my wizard has reached the end of his life. He will die quietly in his sleep. *You'll either make a new wizard or step away from the game.*

Then, each player describes their favorite moment from the past three months of play involving themselves or their wizard.

Finally, each player recites their wizard's name and titles.

Changing of Years

Discuss as a group whether you wish to continue playing, if any players wish to step away, or if you want to skip forward in time. [footnote: *Book of Stars*, page XXXX.]

Going around the table, each player chooses 1 from the Changing of Seasons list.

Then, any player picks up *The Grimoire*. The other players go around and each recollect their favorite moment from the past year involving that player. *The Grimoire* is then passed to the next player. This continues until every player has reminisced about a favorite moment with every other player.

Finally, to conclude the changing of years, each player speaks aloud the truth of their Celestial Audience, in descending order, followed by one final statement:

- *The Sorcerer says*: “There is always more to learn.”
- *The Sage says*: “We dream of another world.”
- *The Faustian says*: “Everything has a price.”
- *The Mariner says*: “All wizards are mighty.”
- *The Warlock says*: “All wizards are men.”
- *The Hierophant says*: “All wizards are lonely.”
- *The Necromancer says*: “All wizards are mortal.”
- *All wizards remaining in the game say*: “The Pact is upheld.”
- *All players who are leaving the game say*: “The dream will live on.”

Codex-Specific Rules

Part IV of each wizard's Codex governs the Principles of their Watcher Role, and accompanying this are rules for concepts specific to their Domain, or areas of play which they're expected to govern over. These rules are invoked by their associated Watcher when that Watcher believes them to be warranted. These include:

- **Rules for Dying**, *Book of Gates*, page XXXX.
- **Funerary Rites**, *Book of Gates*, page XXXX.
- **Rules for Companions**, *Book of Flames*, page XXXX.
- **Rules for Combat**, *Book of Thrones*, page XXXX.
- **Rules for Travel**, *Book of Storms*, page XXXX.
- **Rules of the Devil**, *Book of Chains*, page XXXX.
- **Rules for Time-Skips**, *Book of Stars*, page XXXX.
- **Rules for Research**, *Book of Truth*, page XXXX.
- **Breaking Pact-Law**, *Book of Truth*, page XXXX.

Each Codex also has laws which govern their specific Domain, etiquette and maturity as you move through it, and what one has to watch out for while engaged.

Powerful Denizens

From undead abominations beyond the Gates of Death and dragons borne upon clouds of flame, to know-it-all prophets and wizardly aspirants, there is no shortage of individuals and groups who can meddle in the Pact's operations. These especially Powerful Denizens can be distinguished from the normal rank and file by their ability to in some fashion (perhaps magical, social, physical, or financial) to impact the Pact's Domains on a scale comparable to a wizard. Many of these beings can be used by the Pact towards more productive ends, but they always run the risk of turning against their keepers.

Anatomy of a Denizen

A Powerful Denizen is composed of the following parts:

- **Public Name**, that which people call the Denizen. [footnote: This is probably not the Denizen's Secret Name, per page XXXX.]
- **Taxonomy**, its category (or categories) of being, with the relevant Codex and page number.
- **Status**, if the Denizen is Reliable, Disruptive, Malignant, and so on.
- **Goal**, the long-term goal the Denizen is working towards.
- **Methods**, how the Denizen will work towards their goal in the rules of the game.

- **Truths**, a list of true statements about the Denizen. This includes Wards (if the Denizen has any) and special abilities gained from their Taxonomy.
- **Treasures**, any magic items possessed by the Denizen.

Monstrous Taxonomy

Powerful Humans

While the King of Isha lacks any magic, he still is capable of exerting a great deal of control over the Pact. Certain powerful humans qualify as Powerful Denizens through social authority, magical artifacts, or sheer weight of numbers.

Singularly powerful humans include:

- **Ghoul-Callers**, those who hide out at the edge of death and steal dead souls to try and learn magic. *Book of Gates*, page XXXX.
- **Prophets**, those who have seen into the Immortal Flame and have convinced others of their teachings. *Book of Flames*, page XXXX.
- **Errant Nobles**, nobility in exile from the Court who use their financial and social connections to establish their own fiefdoms. *Book of Thrones*, page XXXX.
- **Heroes**, humans who have obtained a magical weapon and now stumble around trying to help people out. *Book of Thrones*, page XXXX.
- **Occultists**, humans who have been given a taste of power by the Devil and now crave more. *Book of Chains*, page XXXX.
- **Druids**, humans who have earned the affection of the fairies. *Book of Stars*, page XXXX.
- **Arcanists**, humans who have stolen a small fragment of magic from the Pact and now seek to expand their knowledge. *Book of Truth*, page XXXX.
- **Witches**, women magic-users who have their own forms of magic and own practices against the Pact. *Book of Truth*, page XXXX.

Groups of people can include:

- **Cults**, or large-scale folk religions that go against the Immortal Flame. *Book of Flames*, page XXXX.
- **Armies**, deployments of soldiers and ships that act on behalf of a noble. *Book of Thrones*, page XXXX.

- **Conspiracies**, or secret societies working on behalf of the Devil. *Book of Chains*, page XXXX.

Powerful Non-Humans

Great beasts, undead malignancies, demons from beyond the stars — all are united in their horrendous and terrible power. These monstrosities rival a wizard in strength, although they may have a different relationship to magic, and the presence of even a single one of these horrors in Isha poses an existential threat to the Pact.

Powerful non-human Denizens include:

- **The Petty Dead**, masses of undead warriors bound to the will of their summoner. *Book of Gates*, page XXXX.
- **Undead Malignancies**, beings who have forced their way out of death and back into the realm of the living. *Book of Gates*, page XXXX.
- **Beasts**, giant monsters who threaten to rampage across Isha if provoked. *Book of Storms*, page XXXX.
- **Nereids**, elemental women who inhabit the various wild places of the world. *Book of Storms*, page XXXX.
- **Demons**, tortured horrors created during the Tragedies and trapped in the Hells beyond time. *Book of Chains*, page XXXX.
- **Fairies**, magical creatures born from dreams and legends. *Book of Stars*, page XXXX.
- **Angels**, of which very little is known. *Book of Stars*, page XXXX.
- **Constructs**, magical creations who follow the commands of their maker. *Book of Truth*, page XXXX.

Mixing and Matching Taxonomies [box]

Despite the best efforts of the Pact, their taxonomy of the universe cannot possibly encompass everything. If something is both a Prophet and a Foe of Death, or a Nereid and a Construct, or a wizard and a Dragon, work together as the Celestial Audience to faithfully represent them.

Statues

Each Powerful Denizen has a status reflecting their relationship with the Pact:

- **Companion** Denizens act as loyal lovers and associates of a wizard. They are very rare.
- **Reliable** Denizens can be trusted to stay out of the Pact's business and focus on their own concerns, or may even help the Pact when their interests align.
- **Disruptive** Denizens take action without regard to the stability or well-being of the Pact and their Domains, running roughshod through the isles without respect for the wizards of Isha.
- **Malignant** Denizens are actively antagonistic towards the Pact and the world around them.

Companion Denizens and Reliable Denizens stay in their section of their wizard's Domain. Disruptive Denizens will consistently act upon the Domain they're in, creating Complications until convinced to become Reliable or forced out of that Domain. Reliable Denizens can become Disruptive, or Disruptive Denizens can become Reliable, through the choices and outlook of that Denizen. Malignant Denizens will create Complications (similarly to Disruptive Denizens) but cannot be convinced to stop — their very presence inflicts Complications on the Pact wherever they may go.

Scenes With Powerful Denizens [box]

Having a scene with a Powerful Denizen can be a useful opportunity for a wizard to convince the Denizen to see reason. It can be used to convince Disruptive Denizens to become Reliable (in exchange for some kind of favor) or to ask a favor from a Reliable Denizen, often again in exchange for some kind of offering or form of support. If there's something you want from a Powerful Denizen, but you're not sure how to approach it, ask the Watcher in charge of that Denizen what it would cost you to get it. Remember: They may tell you there's nothing you can do.

Goals

The Goal of a Denizen varies based on their Status. A Companion Denizen's Goal is left unwritten, as it's determined by the Flame-Watcher during play. A Reliable Denizen's Goal broadly aligns with the interests of the Pact. Disruptive and Malignant Denizens have Goals that

bring them into conflict with the Pact. Specific Goals can be found as suggestions within the Denizen's relevant Codex.

Method

There are many ways by which a Denizen can act upon Isha to try and achieve its Goals. The Methods available to a Denizen are determined by its Taxonomy — an Errant Noble will have different tools available to him than a Fairy.

Rampaging

Place the Denizen in the Domain of any other wizard. During the Visions Phase of each month, that wizard has a choice — either permit the Denizen to inflict a major Complication on their Domain, or chase the Denizen into another Domain, causing both Domains to suffer a minor Complication.

Manipulating

Place the Denizen in the Domain of any other wizard. During the Visions Phase of each month, give that wizard a major Gift and give each other wizard a minor Complication.

Conjuring

Place the Denizen in the Domain of any other wizard. During the Quiet Phase of each month, this Denizen casts a spell to further their Goal using the magic at their disposal. Create an Impact based on the results of the spell.

Occupying

Place the Denizen in the Domain of any other wizard. No one may schedule Time on anything within the Domain (besides the Denizen). During the Visions Phase of each month, give the Domain a major Gift or two minor Gifts to reflect the Denizen's work to keep the Domain secure.

Other Methods

If none of these Methods feel apt, the Denizen's Watcher may always create their own. Certain Denizens (like Ghoul-Callers or Errant Nobles) have their own Methods outlined in their Codex. Sometimes a Denizen's Method will be shaped by their rules. For instance, an Army requires food and legitimacy in order to operate.

Truths & Treasures

The Truths and Treasures of a Denizen determine the powers available to it, both mechanical and narrative. These are used by the Watcher responsible for the Denizen during scenes and when called for by the Denizen's Method. Some of these will be listed by the rules of the Denizen in their relevant Codex, but may be added to by the Celestial Audience over the course of play.

A Denizen can fit into multiple Taxonomies simultaneously. If they do, they may access the Truths and Treasures granted by all of their relevant Taxonomies.

Interpretative Lenses

Seven-Part Pact is presented before you as a kaleidoscopic array, a vast arrangement of mechanics and stories which together interlock in perfect harmony. However, such a presentation is always incomplete. No matter how precise the mechanisms of text operate amongst each other, there is always the challenge of interpretation: how the machine so delicately presented to your table emerges to force itself upon your Pact. To make matters worse, language is imprecise, the meanings of words ever-shifting, and with even the most simple of arrays it can be difficult to fathom what the author took for granted and what the author assumed you were already familiar with. And this is no simple array!

Collectively it is the responsibility of the Celestial Audience to decipher the interlocking mechanisms of this game and transform them into a harmonious injunction of pure conceptual meaning, which your table can enact upon each other to perfectly model the cosmos of the Wizards of Isha in the years preceding their collapse. As one voyages deeper into these tomes, they will encounter historical contradictions, ambiguities and uncertainties, and occasionally interactions which work against any reasonable imagination of operations. If one wishes to see Isha clearly, they must develop a variety of Lenses through which they can look at the world as it

is hinted to you. Every player will take their own approach to this interpretive process, and develop their own set of methodologies and approaches to seeing Isha clearly. There is no correct interpretation of the texts. Every table will be different, for which Lenses utilized by any Watcher and which of those they prioritize will vary tremendously.

These are some of the possible Lenses one can use when interpreting and extrapolating on ***Seven-Part Pact***. There are others as well.

What Do You Think? [box]

When faced with a conundrum between multiple possible options, identify the Watcher of the Celestial Audience whose Agenda covers its outcome and ask them: "What do you think?" Oftentimes this Watcher is you.

Literalist

Literalism emerges when you understand *The Seven-Part Pact* is actually a series of words ordered precisely in their meaning, with each ambiguity or loophole resolved through the precise meaning of the text, and it can be "taken at its word." The Literalist Lens involves looking up the dictionary definition of various words and reading through the sentence to pinpoint specific words chosen, assuming *The Seven-Part Pact* contains all knowledge about Isha which it could itself possibly contain, and anything outside of its description must not exist at all, and applying the precise usage of words to your Pact, even if it would create a world which doesn't align with sense or expectation. [footnote: In some spaces they refer to this as Rules-As-Written.]

Comparative

The Comparative Lens emerges when you understand *The Seven-Part Pact* is actually a work of art in conversation with other works of art, to exist in a broad lineage of wizardly stories, games, and adventures. The Comparative Lens involves pulling out other stories about Wizards or other games to inform how you decipher the language of *The Seven-Part Pact*, applying the logic of other games and other Wizards to determine areas of the game left untouched, and using the form and structure of these other games to adjust the structure of *The Seven-Part Pact* to align with your expectations. [footnote: This also covers someone searching online to find out what other players have decided on.]

Intentionalist

Intentionalism emerges when you understand *The Seven-Part Pact* was actually a work of art created by an author (or authors) as an act of self-expression, every word placed to precisely invoke a specific meaning, and the ambiguity between your own understanding of the text and the author's desires can be solved if you can understand their perspective. The Intentionalist Lens involves identifying what you believe the author may have meant with the sentence you're examining, trying to "get into the mind of the author" to produce further portions of the Faraway Sea which align with your perception of the author's desires, and aligning yourself with the desires of the author in order to produce a version of the Pact which you believe fits with how the author's secret desires. [footnote: In some spaces they refer to this as Rules-As-Intended.]

Diegetic

The Diegetic Lens emerges when you understand *The Seven Part Pact* is actually a fuzzy and imprecise representation of a real place, the Faraway Sea and the Archipelago of Isha. The text itself was composed in that world and was translated through the ceaseless work of thoughtful scholars into our own, and any emergent ambiguities or contradictions would be resolved if one was fully present in Isha. The Diegetic Lens involves imagining Isha as it truly is and imagining the logic of that culture and that world, and attempting to deduce what was lost through translation, expanding on Isha's presented logic to imagine how they would approach other topics, and producing the logic of the Faraway Sea as you understand it, correcting for poor translations in other parts of the text.

Playful

The Playful Lens emerges when you understand *The Seven-Part Pact* is actually just a game being played between friends, who have their own desires and needs that supersede the claims made by the text. The Playful Lens involves identifying what would lend itself towards the more enjoyable or compelling interaction or situation, prioritizing what will produce enjoyable game-states, fun experiences, and compelling moments, even if there's no deeper logic behind it, and going with what's going to produce the most fun for everyone, even if it directly conflicts with the text as it's written.

Radical

Radicalism emerges when you understand *The Seven-Part Pact* wields no unique authority over the game you play, that the connection between the text and the act of playing is tenuous at best, and you have no allegiance to its composition. The Radical Lens means completely rejecting what the text itself says in favor of your own approach, introducing any new elements you wish, even if they completely contradict the tone of the text, and doing whatever you want, even if it no longer bears any resemblance to *The Seven-Part Pact*.

Play Reconfigured

The rules of ***Seven-Part Pact*** are not exhaustive. Events will transpire which these rules could not anticipate, occurrences that rework and rewrite the fundamental nature of the game being played. This process will vary depending on the interests and inclinations of the Celestial Audience. [footnote: In fact, by the very nature of being an infinite game, it's impossible for the author to exhaustively predict the ways in which the game *could* change.] This is some incomplete guidance and support on implementing various kinds of game-changing events into ***Seven-Part Pact***.

Adding Other Books

The easiest way to fundamentally change ***Seven-Part Pact*** is to incorporate other books. These might be expansions, new rulesets written to be compatible with ***Seven-Part Pact***, or system-neutral materials that document aspects of the fictional world. The Celestial Audience may even choose to write their own books and implement them into the game. New spells, schools of magic, Denizens, and Domains can be easily swapped in and out as wizards uncover lost knowledge from the past.

Gamechanging Impact

A Gamechanging Impact is, by its nature, something that fundamentally shifts the core rules of a Domain at the table. Redesigning a Domain can force it to no longer resemble the original play materials. This can be implemented through craft supplies, tape, marker, and gumption. There is no limit to the degree to which a Domain can be changed, as long as it follows the fiction laid

out by the Celestial Audience. [footnote: Aspiring game designers can be tempted to fundamentally change Domains in a "gimmicky" fashion, reworking elements for the sake of having reworked them. Experimentation is encouraged, but be mindful of the other players at your table, and focus on changes that emerge naturally from the events of play.]

Example of Play: The Court of the Ebon King

In the 1st week of February in the 19th year of the Age of Knives, the Ebon King [once named Rattletrap, now known only as the Watcher of the Gates, played by Sara] destroyed the Gates of Death, and restructured the afterlife in his own image.

"Here's what I was thinking—" Says Sara with a huge smile on her face.

"I'm glad you've got something in mind because I have no clue where to go from here." Says the Truth-Watcher.

"Basically, what if I replace the Domain of Death with a dark mirror of the Warlock's Domain. So there's a King of Death and then attendant dignitaries and Fiat, Wealth, and Might and Clans..."

"That sounds really cool, but do the dead care about wealth?" Asks the Throne-Watcher.

"I can use Soul tokens for wealth. That feels appropriately morbid."

"And what are the equivalent of clans?" Asks the Star-Watcher, who has been eying Rattletrap's face-down Destiny this entire conversation.

"I have a couple ideas for what that could be," says the Chain-Watcher, flipping to the part of their Codex with the list of Hells.]

Working Together [box]

In other tabletop role-playing games, it's one player's unique job to invent new rules and mechanics and implement them into the game. In **Seven-Part Pact**, it's important all interested players are working together to implement these changes and are weighing in on their design. The creation of new game components is not the sole responsibility of any one member of the Celestial Audience.

The Certainty of the Pact

The Pact is as unbreakable and true as the mountains or the seas, as fundamental to the consciousness of man as the divine right of kings. Individual wizards may rise and fall, their powers waxing and waning, their desire eclipsing and threatening the firmament upon which the Pact is built. The rules of the game may change fundamentally, the rites of wizards unrecognizable from what came before.

But the Pact will not fall.

If the Pact did fall, one must presume that it would be the responsibility of the present wizards to work together to build whatever comes next, abandoning the rules of their world and building something new. Such a world would be destined for tragedy, its firmaments unsteady, its cosmos likely to fall apart into a useless anarchy. The stars would be unbalanced, the laws lacking design, the social order upended. To imagine such a world without the pact and the stewardship of the wizards present would be a fool's fancy. It could not last.

Such a world is far beyond the scope of these books.

Impact

Shared Impact

Minor Impact

Gifts

- Introduce a Denizen who could serve as the Wizard's Companion, if he chooses to charm them.
- Have a Wizard's Companion improve his Isle or Sanctum, inviting him to change or add to the Lore.
- Grant a Wizard a substance which gives +1 to one of his Elemental Circles for the scene he consumes it, such as liquor, soap, or narcotics.

- Grant the Wizard a Treasure of some kind.

Complications

- Inform the Wizard one of his Companions is in danger or needs assistance — he must schedule Time this month to help them or else this Companion will be unable or unwilling to provide Care in the future.
- Change the Lore of the Wizard's Sanctum or Isle to make it worse.
- Take away one of the Wizard's Treasures, stealing it off to some other group or destroying it.
- Injure one of the Wizard's Companions, forcing him to heal them if he wishes for their Care.

Major Impact

Gifts

- Grant a Wizard a rare and valuable alchemical substance, which he may expend any time he casts a Spell to change one die to any Glyph of his choice.
- Offer someone eager and willing to help the Wizard, who can serve as an extra Week of Time during this or next month.

Complications

- Damage the Wizard's Pact-Fragment, rendering him unable to use its blessings until it is repaired.
- Instantly kill one of the Wizard's Companions.
- Threaten the Wizard with death, potentially killing them. (*Ask the Gate-Watcher for help.*)
- Create a Powerful Denizen in that wizard's Domain.

Impact on the Necromancer

Minor Impact

Gifts

- Move a Soul further into Death.
- Turn a Hostile Gate non-Hostile.

Complications

- Move a Soul closer to Life.
- Add 1-4 new Souls to the Edge of Life.
- Add a new Disruptive Ghoul-Caller to the Edge of Life.
- Create a new Foe in the Gates of Death.
- Turn a Gate Hostile.

Major Impact

Gifts

- Create a new Ally in any Gate.
- Move a Foe further into Death.
- Remove a Foe from the Gates of Death (through obliteration).
- Add a new Reliable Ghoul-Caller to the Edge of Life.

Complications

- Move a Foe closer to Life.
- Create 2+ new Foes in the Gates of Death.
- Move all Foes closer to life.
- Add 5+ Souls to the Edge of Life.
- Destroy a Gate.

Gamechanging Impact

- Add or remove the steps connecting Gates, changing the path between them.
- Create a new Gate of Death, and mark steps connecting it to the other Gates.
- Create a new exit or entrance point within the Gates of Death (such as another way to access the Void Beyond, Final Death, or the Edge of Life).
- Replace the Necromancer's Domain with a different Domain redesigned to focus on death.

Impact on the Hierophant

Minor Impact

Gifts

- Remove 1 Woe from a Supplicant.
- Place 1 Abundance or Conviction onto any Temple.
- Move any amount of Abundance or Conviction from any Temple onto Temple Hestar.
- Place a Holiday Marker on a Temple.

Complications

- Remove 1 Abundance or Conviction from any Temple.
- Place a new Supplicant with 2-3 Woe on any Temple.
- Remove a Holiday Marker from a Temple.
- Place Woe onto a Supplicant.

Major Impact

Gifts

- Distribute 4+ Conviction and Abundance amongst any combination of Temples.
- Remove a Supplicant from a Temple.
- Give the Hierophant the chance to change a Temple's Doctrine, and ask what he wishes to change it to.

- Create a Reliable Prophet on any Temple.

Complications

- Place multiple Supplicants with 2-3 Woe each on any combination of Temples (besides Temple Hestar).
- Place 2+ Woe on a Supplicant.
- Create a Cult in any other wizard's Domain, and place 2 Abundance and 2 Conviction onto it.
- Turn a Reliable Prophet Disruptive.

Gamechanging Impact

- Create a new Temple, located either within the Hierophant's Domain or in another wizard's Domain.
- Create a new Class or new Doctrine.
- Destroy Temple Hestar.

Impact on the Warlock

Minor Impact

Gifts

- Move 1-2 Authority from any Ideology to the King.
- Replace a Lord in the Agenda with any Lord of the Warlock's choice.
- Add a new Lady to the King's Confidants from any Clan.
- Assign an unclaimed Title to any Clan.
- Give +1 Favor to any Clan with 0 Favor.

Complications

- Move 1-2 Authority from the King to any Ideology.
- Distract any number of Lords.
- Add a Lord to the King's Agenda this month from any Clan.

- Send a Lord on a Quest.
- Have a Lord's Action occur immediately.
- Remove all Favor from any Clan.
- Kill any Lord or Lady.

Major Impact

Gifts

- Move all Authority from one or more Ideologies to the King.
- Replace any number of Lords in the Agenda with any Lord of the Warlock's choice.
- Give +1 Favor to each Clan.

Complications

- Move 3+ Authority from the King to any Ideology.
- Add 2+ Lords from any Clan to the King's Agenda.
- Create an Army in any wizard's Domain.
- Turn a Lady into an Errant Lady and place her in any other Domain.
- Kill the King.

Gamechanging Impact

- Add one or more new Titles with custom rules.
- Create a new Clan or Ideology.
- Change how the King operates and how his signs are determined.
- Replace the Warlock's Domain with a different Domain redesigned to focus on power.

Impact on the Mariner

Minor Impact

Gifts

- Place a Ship on a Route.

- Place a Market on an Isle.
- Replace a Raider Ship with a normal Ship.
- Remove a Storm token from a Ravaged Isle.

Complications

- Remove a Ship from a Route.
- Remove a Market from an Isle.
- Replace a Ship with a Raider Ship.
- Place a Storm in a Sea.
- Place a Nesting Beast on an Isle.

Major Impact

Gifts

- Move many Storms from Isha, following the directional movement of the Wind.
- Remove many Storms from multiple Seas.
- Give a Market a Rarity.

Complications

- Place a Typhoon in a Sea.
- Place a Distrusting Beast in a Sea.
- Change the dominant direction of the Wind, and add Storms on its Horizon.
- Experience a natural disaster. [footnote: For examples of natural disasters and how they may be represented in play, look at the Mariner's *Watching the Stars* on page XXXX of *The Book of Storms*.]
- Ravage an Isle.

Gamechanging Impact

- Add or remove an Isle from the Archipelago, and reorganize the associated Routes.
- Use a different map of a different archipelago.
- Replace the Mariner's Domain with a different Domain redesigned to focus on trade and nature.

Impact on the Faustian

Minor Impact

Gifts

- Remove a Scheme from any Community and put it in the Defeated Schemes.
- Move a random card from the Devil's Machinations back into the Devil's Deck.
- Place an Accomplice on any Community.

Complications

- Place a Scheme from the Devil's Deck on any Community.
- Move 1-2 cards from the Faustian's Deck into the Devil's Machinations.
- Create a Pawn in any Community.

Major Impact

Gifts

- Remove any number of Schemes from any Community and put them in the Defeated Schemes.
- Move a card from the Devil's Deck to the Faustian's Deck.
- Move a card from the Devil's Machinations to the Defeated Schemes.
- Create 2 or more Accomplices in any combination of Communities.

Complications

- Place 2 or more Schemes from the Devil's Deck in any Community.
- Take any number of Accomplices and move them to the Devil's Machinations.
- Create a Conspiracy in any Community.
- Declare any Denizen is an Antagonist of the Pact.
- Give the Devil a second Twist from the Faustian's Deck.

Gamechanging Impact

- Add a new Community, and determine how the Devil places Schemes on that Community.
- Add a new suit of cards to the Devil's Deck and determine what they do.
- Add a new kind of hand to the Devil's Machinations.
- Replace the Faustian's Domain with a different Domain redesigned to focus on conflict.

Impact on the Sage

Minor Impact

Gifts

- Place an Omen on a Denizen.
- Move an Omen from a Denizen onto the Pact.

Complications

- Move an Omen from the Pact onto any Denizen.
- Remove an Omen from any Denizen.
- Show the Chain-Watcher a face-down Destiny of their choice.

Major Impact

Gifts

- Place 2-3 Omens on any character.
- Give an important or compelling Denizen an apt Destiny.
- Move any number of Omens from a Denizen onto an Accepted Destiny.

Complications

- Flip a face-down Destiny face-up.
- Remove any number of Omens from the Pact.

- Move any number of Omens from the Pact onto a Rejected Destiny.
- Strip away a Denizen's Destiny, removing all Omens from them.
- Change the Dreaming from Calm to Uncertain, or from Uncertain to Chaotic.

Gamechanging Impact

- Add new Destinies to the Destiny Deck.
- Create a new state for the Dreaming to occupy.
- Add a new Future (similar to the Future of the Pact) that can hold Omens independently from the Pact.
- Replace the Sage's Domain with a different Domain redesigned to focus on dreaming.

Impact on the Sorcerer

Minor Impact

Gifts

- Place 1-3 Knowledge in the Sorcerer's Tower.
- Create a Student.
- Promote a Student to a Researcher, Professor, or Librarian.

Complications

- Flip a Researcher over — they are not operational this month, but may return to their job next month.
- Steal a Tome or Reagent from the Tower and give it to any magic-user.
- Kill a Student, Researcher, Professor, Librarian, or Alchemist.

Major Impact

Gifts

- Place 4+ Knowledge in the Sorcerer's Tower.
- Give the Sorcerer's Tower Reagents or Tomes.

- Place a Researcher in any Domain or on the Orrery.
- Create a Professor, Librarian, or Alchemist in the Sorcerer's Tower.
- Add an Innovation to the Grimoire.

Complications

- Add an Arcanist to the Sorcerer's Tower.
- Steal *all* Tomes or Reagents from the Tower and give them to any magic-user.
- Kill multiple Academics and/or Researchers.
- Remove 1+ Innovations from the Grimoire.

Gamechanging Impact

- Add a new Alchemical Recipe, a new kind of Academic, or a new way to obtain Knowledge.
- Create a new School of Magic, and with it a new Arcanist.
- Replace the Sorcerer's Domain with a different Domain redesigned to focus on magic and knowledge.

Ages

Age of Awakening

The sages say that magic is dying, and yet behold the lightning! Behold the stone that rusts and the ancient trees catching the last rays of light as the sun sets over the Faraway Sea. Magic lies sleeping in every nook and cranny, waiting for the old names to be spoken once more.

Materials for **Three to Seven Wizards** beginning a **Long-Running Campaign** set within **Seven-Part Pact**.

The Complexity of this Age is for **Journeymages** (Players should have some passing familiarity with **Seven-Part Pact**, or the group is a mixture of neophytes and experienced players.)

One player acts as Facilitator. The role of the Facilitator is determined by the sorts of experience possessed by the other players. If the other players have experience with board games and video games, the Facilitator should play the **Sage**. If the other players have experience with improv and storytelling, the Facilitator should play the **Sorcerer**. If the other players are experienced with GMless and indie TTRPGs, the Facilitator should play the **Faustian**.

Preparation

The Facilitator should prepare beforehand by reading through this entire Age and consulting the sections of other Codexes referenced in this Age. They should also familiarize themselves with their wizard's Codex and have a sense of what choices they want to make for their wizard, so they can help the rest of the Pact prepare.

If players have time to prepare beforehand, each player should read through this Age in full, and follow all instructions provided within (picking a wizard and making choices for that wizard), with the following exceptions:

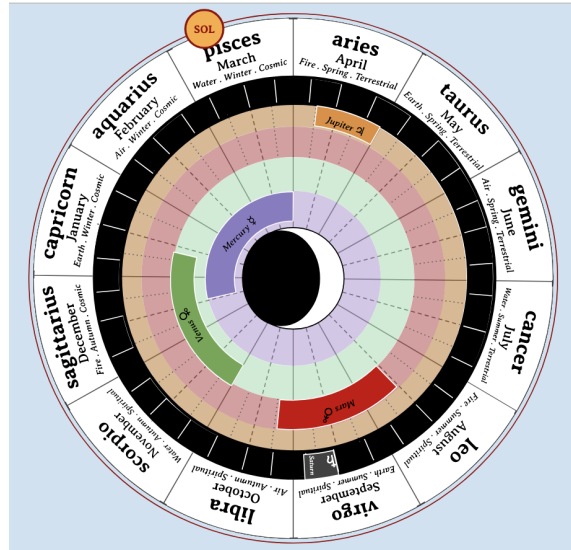
- Wait for Introductions & Titles until all Wizards have completed their character.
- Read only your own Wizard's section for Govern (Part III).

If there are fewer than seven players, the Facilitator should take responsibility for each missing Watcher role and read the corresponding wizards's sections under *If A Wizard Is Missing* on page XXXX.

The Orrery

Choose one of the following arrangements for the Orrery at the start of play:

- The Orrery begins in the month of March with Sol in Pisces, Saturn in the third placement of Virgo, Jupiter beginning one quarter of the way in Aries, Mars beginning halfway in Leo, Venus beginning in Scorpio, and Mercury beginning halfway through Sagittarius.
- [FIGURE OUT ADDITIONAL POSITIONS]



Imagine

The Facilitator reads aloud:

Many thought magic was lost entirely. In the centuries following the Pact's foundation, Magic slowly slipped from the knowledge of the world, its power relegated to the footnotes of historians and the anxieties of old women. The Wizards of the Pact did nothing to challenge this notion. The great masters of bygone ages were too paranoid, or perhaps too wise, to allow their Prentices the secrets of their magic in full. Many of the great dangers of the Pact have been forgotten — the Devil is dead, the Gates are quiet, the ancient days are long gone. It has been at least a decade since a member of the Pact cast a single spell from the Grimoire of ancient times, and there may even be those amongst us who proudly consider themselves "theoretical magicians" — those who study magic without ever actually whispering a single incantation. Generation by generation, magic slowly waned. But now, amid the darkness of his cave, the Sage stirs. His visions are plagued by nightmares of destruction, of the forgotten magic of ancient years returning to consume the archipelago of Isha. For the first time in many years, the Wizards of the Pact convene beneath the starlit sky, to discuss the future of their world, and to rekindle that which was lost at the heart of Isha.

Discuss together:

- How interested are we in the impact of magic's decline?

- Are there particular relationships to magic we're interested in exploring?
- The Palette Grid and where you'd place each topic.

Empower (Part I)

Each player chooses a Codex and completes Part I of their Codex, making choices for their wizard.

Starting with the Facilitator and going clockwise around the table, each player introduces their Wizard with his name, age, pact-fragment, familiar, appearance (including visible changes from magic), and what is publicly known about his old master.

Next, collectively answer a few questions, and assign titles to our Wizards. These titles aren't necessarily caused by the events described in the title, although they could be.

- Who is the oldest Wizard? *He is titled "Archmagus."*
- Who is the youngest Wizard? *He is titled "Neophyte."*
- One of us cast a spell in secret, and another one of us saw him do so. Who was involved? What happened? *One has the title "the Wise" and the other has the title "the Quiet."*
- One of us believes that the world must learn to fear magic again, and the other has firsthand experience with magic's dark potential. How did you two argue? Why haven't you forgiven each other yet? *One has the title "Butcher of Ishana" and the other has the title "of the Forbidden Tome."*
- One of us believes an ancient threat still menaces the Pact, another dismisses the fear as nonsensical, and a third wizard is torn between both. What is this evil? What evidence demonstrates its absence? *Choose from the titles: "Thief-King," "Sivertongue," and "the Lonely"*

Befriend (Part II)

Look through Part II and observe your Wizard's Isle and Sanctum. Make a change or addition to the Lore of your Isle reflecting the magic fading from the world, transforming something fantastical into something mundane or practical. Then make a change or addition to your Sanctum, reflecting your own personal taste and style.

Choose four Companions, one for each of your Elements. You are estranged and currently not on speaking terms with any Companions chosen for a Circle with o.

Govern (Part III)

Although the Pact is much weaker than it used to be, each Wizard is still the lord of his Domain. Each Wizard reads through the Rules of his Domain (or at least the Summary), and then chooses how to prepare his Domain. Each player's Domain begins in a Quiet Arrangement. If the player feels confident, they may choose instead to have it begin in a Dynamic Arrangement. Each wizard also makes the following modifications to their Domain:

- **Necromancer:** The Laws of Death have been forgotten. Ask the Facilitator to secretly choose a third Law to reveal at the worst moment.
- **Hierophant:** The people do not believe in magic. Take -2 Abundance and -2 Conviction from Temple Hestar.
- **Warlock:** The King does not believe in magic. His Sun Sign is Gemini and his other signs are for you to choose. Ergoism cannot gain Authority from Watching The Stars.
- **Faustian:** The Devil is considered dead. Set the Devil's Twist with any 2.
- **Sage:** Magic is slipping away. Remove 3 Omens from the Pact. The Dreaming is Uncertain.
- **Sorcerer:** The Laws of Magic have been forgotten. Ask the Facilitator to secretly choose a third Law to reveal at the worst moment.

If a Wizard is Missing

If there are fewer than seven players, the Facilitator should choose and implement the following for each wizard:

- **Without a Necromancer,** the dead are not respected and honored the way they once were, and their burials are often disturbed and forgotten. Perhaps hauntings are more frequent, mass graves are more common, and the wreckage of the past is ignored and left to rot.
- **Without a Hierophant,** the people and religious institutions of Isha, and perhaps even the Wizards' own Companions, no longer believe in magic. Wizards are eccentric sages at best, and heretical witches at worst. The Pact has no social authority, receives no special treatment or respect within Isha, and should a member of the Pact act in a way which the Celestial Audience feels would dismay the public, the public will demand his death (*Book of Flames*, page XXXX).

- ***Without a Warlock***, the King and his court no longer believe in magic. They laugh at the notion of Wizards, and dismiss them as superstition. The Pact has no legal authority, and are just as bound to the laws of the Kingdom of Isha as any other man, and should a member of the Pact kill someone the King will declare him a murderer and seek his punishment, sending an Army into his Domain. (*Book of Thrones*, page XXXX).
- ***Without a Mariner***, the seas grow rough and cruel, and sailors hunt the wild beasts to extinction. There are no magical creatures in Isha anymore. The island of the Orrery is unable to be reached by mundane means. Wizards cannot schedule Time to change the Orrery, and the Wizardmoot instead takes place in the Sanctum of the Archmagus. This can be fixed if anyone finds a way to magically clear the seas around the Orrery, or otherwise establish a pathway there.
- ***Without a Faustian***, the Devil has gone quiet. The Pact grows complacent and relaxed. As they develop their Domains, ask each member of the Pact if they've compromised on their morality in the pursuit of power and stability. Those who have compromised each receive a Gift. Those who have remained steady each receive a Complication.
- ***Without a Sage***, the future of the Pact is murky and unclear. False prophets speak of new eras and new changes, visions of alternate worlds without the Pact. The Pact feels like an irrelevant relic from an older age.
- ***Without a Sorcerer***, the Pact lacks any direction or focus. Amateur wizards fashion themselves as deserving of the power of the Pact. Should a wizard cast a spell in front of a group of people, create a Disruptive Arcanist (*Book of Truth*, page XXXX).

Witness (Part IV & V)

Going around, each Wizard introduces his Watcher Role, the truth he stands for, and reads out what he will watch out for during other Wizards' scenes.

This Age contains no changes to the Rules and Lore described in Parts IV & V of the various Codexes.

The Gate-Watcher should watch out for... the deaths of various characters, the way death is shaped by modernity, signs of the metaphorical dying of magic itself.

The Flame-Watcher should watch out for... the common folk's opinions on magic, how the church thinks about wizards, how wizards are treated when they're out in the world.

The Throne-Watcher should watch out for... how masculinity and power are defined without magic, how the King attempts to position himself over the Pact, how Wizards are kept in line by the law.

The Storm-Watcher should watch out for... how wild creatures are vanishing from this world, how the loss of magic is reflected in the beauty of the world, how even mundane creatures can feel this loss.

The Chain-Watcher should watch out for... how magic disrupts the status quo, how social forces react to magic's use, how the Devil demonstrates he's secretly still alive.

The Star-Watcher should watch out for... other emerging threats and plotlines that connect to events in the Pact, opportunities to bridge one Domain into another, ways to invite less confident members of the Celestial Audience to speak up.

The Truth-Watcher should watch out for... how magic may be misused by those unfamiliar with its power, how magic ripples outwards and shapes those far beyond it, how other practitioners of magic may respond to the Pact's revival.

Opening The Game

Begin the *Age of Awakening* with the Wizardmoot. As the Orrery is not presently accessible, it must be set at the Archmagus's Sanctum. Ask the Archmagus to describe his Sanctum and where he entertains his guests. Then ask: "*Who is early? Who is late?*"

As each wizard arrives, invite them to describe their arrival, introducing their character to the Pact. Use this as a chance to practice roleplaying as your character and embodying your wizard. Each wizard is invited to discuss the current state of his Domain, and express his worries to the Pact.

Once the scene concludes, begin the first month by advancing the Orrery.

Age of Dominion

I am a man, world-conquering, steel-forging.

I am the open grave, soil-drowning, worms-devouring.

I am the man's love, grieving his death, carrying his child.

I am the open blade, taking her life, ending his tale.

I am the budding flower, green from red, life from death.

I am the wintertime, breath-robbing, green-rotting.

I am the fire, lightning-born, wild and warm.

I am a man, master of lightning, tamer of flame.

Materials for **Three to Seven Wizards** beginning a **Long-Running Campaign** set within **Seven-Part Pact**.

The Complexity of this Age is for **Magi** or **Archmagi** (all players should be familiar with the Seven-Part Pact and have played in at least one Age before this one).

The Facilitator may play as **any wizard**.

Preparation

All players should read through this Age and familiarize themselves with their Codex before play.

If players have time to prepare beforehand, each player should follow all instructions provided within (picking a Wizard and making choices for that Wizard), with the following exceptions:

- Wait for Introductions & Titles until all Wizards have completed the Empower section.
- Read only your own Wizard's section for Govern (Part III) and Witness (Part IV & V).

The Orrery will not be set up until the first month begins.

Optional Rule — Remnants of Power [box]

The Pact has ruled over this land for centuries. Is it any surprise that these gods have reshaped the world in their image? If most players are at an Archmagus level of experience, or this isn't your first time playing the Age of Dominion together, one way to enhance the Age is to

give each player their Engagement token at the start of character creation. Over the course of character creation and Domain preparation, they can each spend their Engagement to make dramatic changes to the world of Isha.

Imagine

The Facilitator reads aloud:

The archipelago of Isha is in the midst of a great golden age, a period of splendor and glory, all under the auspice and command of the Seven-Part Pact. For centuries the Pact has kept the peace, the Archipelago of Isha preserved in amber as the shining beacon of their austerity and rule. The glory of the Pact is eternal, but rough months approach. The Sage whispers of a gathering storm in the Lands of Nod, enemies of the Pact who have long conspired in the darkness now dream of its undoing. The Devil rides once more across Isha, and the Pact must prepare to defend their Domains, consolidate power, and keep Isha secure against the coming storm.

Discuss together:

- What do we want to bring to the game that we haven't done before?
- What parts of the game are we most interested in exploring?
- The Palette Grid and where you'd place each topic.

Empower (Part I)

Each player now chooses a Wizard's Codex.

Discuss and fill out the Palette together.

Go through Part I and make choices for your Wizard.

Using Your Engagement [box]

Spend your Engagement during Part I in order to establish your Wizard as having accomplished some monumental feat of personal power, having previously gone on a great and historic quest to some faraway part of the cosmos, or fought some horrible enemy of the Pact and won. This can be represented by creating a custom Treasure

(described either using the Spells of Artifice in the Grimoire, or of your own imagination and with the permission of the Celestial Audience) or a dramatic change to his appearance which goes far beyond any change of magic described in his Codex — which by extension grants him incredible power.

Introduction & Titles

Starting with the Facilitator and going clockwise around the table, each player introduces their Wizard with his name, age, pact-fragment, familiar, appearance (including visible changes from magic), and what is publicly and privately known about his old master.

Next, we collectively answer the following questions:

- Who is the oldest Wizard? *He is titled "Archmagus."*
- Who is the youngest Wizard? *He is titled "Neophyte."*

Each Wizard then asks a number of questions from the lists below. If the Wizard is younger than 2 scores (40 years), he asks one question from his list. If the Wizard is younger than 4 scores (80 years) he asks two questions from his list. He asks all three questions if he's any older. If multiple Wizards answer, assign the Title to the eldest Wizard. If no Wizards answer, take the title for yourself.

Necromancer

- Which of you, if any, have lost the love of your life to Death?
Discuss who was taken, how long ago, and by what methods. Grant him the title: "the Silent."
- Which of you, if any, would've died had I not intervened?
Discuss what would've killed him, how you saved him, and why you acted in that moment. Grant him the title: "Twice-Born."
- Which of you, if any, carry the stench of death with you?
Discuss what death smells like, if it's his own death or others, and whether he knows it. Grant him the title: "of the Nameless Dark."

Hierophant

- Which of you, if any, are devout believers in the truth of the Immortal Flame?
Discuss what sparked this faith, and how the two of you have connected over this belief. Grant him the title: "Temple Father."
- Which of you, if any, did I protect from public scandal?
Discuss what this scandal would've been over and what blackmail you still possess on him. Grant him the title: "the Bastard."
- Which of you, if any, has committed an atrocity against the archipelago?
Discuss what atrocity he committed, what role magic played in this, and why he thought it was necessary. Grant him the title: "Butcher of Ishana."

Warlock

- Which of you, if any, fought by my side in defense of Isha?
Discuss how long ago this war was and what honors you both earned. Grant him the title: "Sir, Knight of the Isles."
- Which of you, if any, did I spare after I defeated you in combat?
Discuss what provoked this duel, what spurred you to spare him, and what reminder you left. Grant him the title: "the Scarred."
- Which of you, if any, have convinced me to murder another on your behalf?
Discuss who you've killed, why he wanted them dead, and why you did it. Grant him the title: "Silvertongue."

Mariner

- Which of you, if any, have traveled with me on a distant quest?
Discuss how long ago this voyage was and what you were looking for. Grant him the title: "the Wanderer."
- Which of you, if any, would have drowned at sea if not for me?
Discuss why you were out at sea together, what great storm threatened them, and why you saved their life. Grant him the title: "Storm-Chaser."
- Which of you, if any, have forced a dragon to kneel before you?
Discuss where he found this dragon, what he did to provoke it, and what has become of it. Grant him the title: "Dragon-Lord."

Faustian

- Which of you, if any, bailed me out of a disastrous situation?
Discuss what kind of mess it was (criminal, romantic, devilish, etc.) and whether I deserved it. Grant him the title: "the Kind."
- Which of you, if any, has been tricked into killing another member of the Pact?
Discuss why it was necessary to kill this Wizard and how you pitted them against each other. Grant him the title: "Oath-Breaker."
- Which of you, if any, have previously made a deal with the Devil?
Discuss what circumstances led to this deal, what the deal was for, and what it cost him. Grant him the title: "Flame-Prince."

Sage

- Which of you, if any, made a great personal sacrifice at my behest?
Discuss what he gave up for you, what toll it took upon him, and whether he believes it was right. Grant him the title: "Custodian of the Orrery."
- Which of you, if any, have sought the wisdom of the fairies?
Discuss how he earned the fairies' trust, what advice the fairies gave him, and what he gave them to receive it. Grant him the title: "Fairy-Friend."
- Which of you, if any, are only part of the Pact due to my prophecizing?
Discuss what about him caught your eye and what greatness you foretold. Grant him the title: "Trismegistus."

Sorcerer

- Which of you, if any, respect me as their mentor and teacher?
Discuss how you taught him and what he learned from you. Grant him the title: "of the Tower."
- Which of you, if any, have I saved from a disastrous spell gone wrong?
Discuss what the spell was trying to do, what it ended up doing, and how many people died as a result. Grant him the title: "the Wise."
- Which of you, if any, have written an academic treatise on magic?
Discuss what kind of magic he focused on and how you helped him. Grant him the title: "Professor Emeritus."

Befriend (Part II)

Look through Part II and observe your Wizard's Isle and Sanctum. Make a change or addition to the Lore of both your Isle and Sanctum to reflect your power and presence as a Wizard.

Choose four Companions, one for each of your Elements. You are estranged and currently not on speaking terms with any Companions chosen for a Circle with o. Create Companions either using the Companions described in your Codex or of your own creation.

Using Your Engagement [box]

Spend your Engagement during Part II in order to make a dramatic and sweeping change to your Isle, Sanctum, and/or Companions. Perhaps your Isle is now a flying castle, your Sanctum is an infinite labyrinth inside a sub-realm, or your Companions are the results of Titanomachy. This can be reflected through any combination of spells in the Grimoire, or by other means if approved by the Celestial Audience.

Govern (Part III)

Each Wizard is the undisputed lord of his Domain. Read through the Rules of your Domain, and then turn to your Section here to make choices and prepare.

If there are fewer than seven players, each missing wizard is considered Silent. Appoint a member of the Celestial Audience to (quickly) justify the Silent wizard's absence and take on his associated Watcher role.

Each wizard's Domain begins Dynamic, although his player may decide for it to begin Explosive if they wish for a challenge.

Using Your Engagement [box]

Spend your Engagement during Part III in order to make a Gamechanging Impact on your Domain, fundamentally changing the structure and rules of your Domain and altering how it operates on a fundamental level.

Witness (Part IV & V)

Going around, each Wizard introduces his Watcher Role, the truth he stands for, and reads out what he will watch out for during other Wizards' scenes.

This Age contains no changes to the Rules and Lore described in Parts IV & V of the various Codexes.

Preparing the Orrery

Each Wizard places his planet anywhere in the Orrery, in the following order:

- The **Gate-Watcher** places Saturn.
- The **Flame-Watcher** places Jupiter.
- The **Throne-Watcher** places Mars.
- The **Storm-Watcher** places Venus.
- The **Chain-Watcher** places Mercury.
- The **Star-Watcher** chooses the season (Spring, Summer, Autumn, or Winter) and places the Sun in the month immediately preceding the chosen Season.
- The **Truth-Watcher** then moves any Planet forwards or backwards.

Remember all Celestial Bodies will move forward at the start of the new month, so don't get attached to any conjunctions before play begins.

Opening The Game

Follow the instructions for The Wizardmoot at the Orrery on page XXXX to begin the game. Once the Wizardmoot has concluded, begin the new month.

Age of Calamity

The great syzygy is upon us! The apocalypse is at hand! Look in the sky, for even the stars know this truth! All things must end, and we must give our lives to its ending!

Materials for **Three to Seven Wizards** beginning a **Short Campaign** set within **Seven-Part Pact**.

The Complexity of this Age is for **Archmagi** (*all players should be intimately familiar with the Seven-Part Pact and should be comfortable navigating the rules of the game*).

The Facilitator may play as **any wizard**.

Preparation

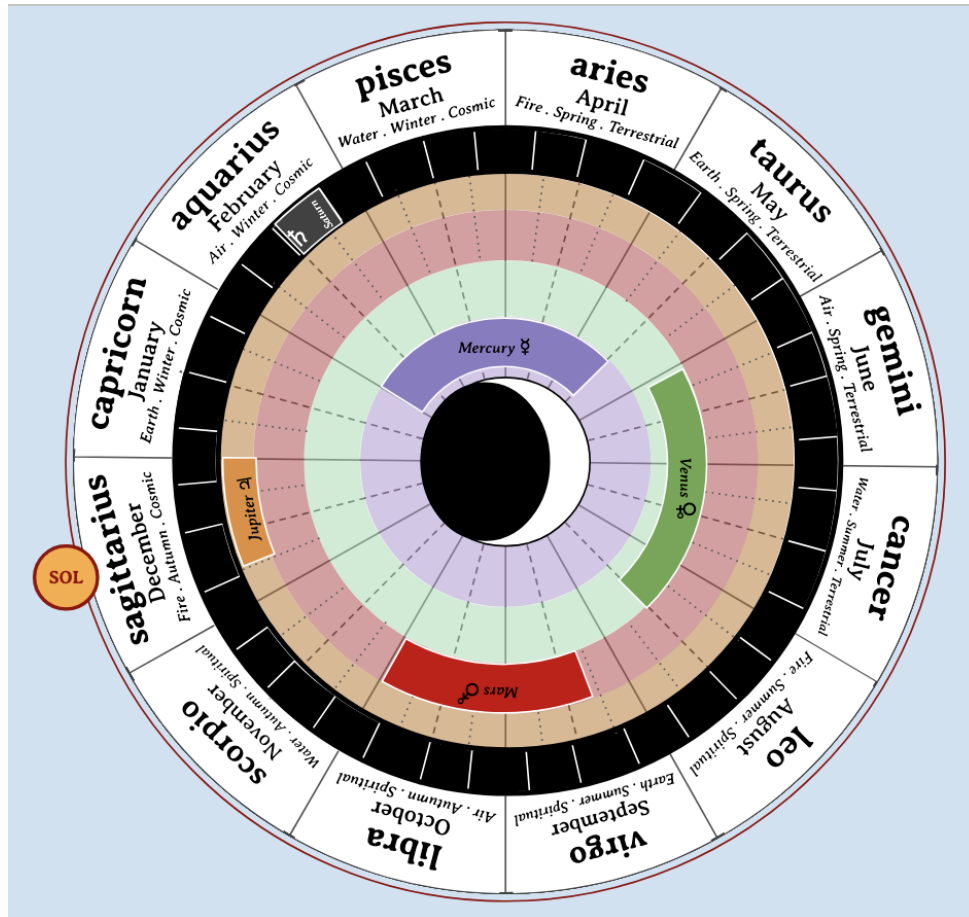
All players should read through this Age and familiarize themselves with their Codex before play.

If players have time to prepare beforehand, each player should follow all instructions provided within (picking a Wizard and making choices for that Wizard), with the following exceptions:

- Wait for Introductions & Titles until all Wizards have completed the Empower section.
- Read only your own Wizard's section for Govern (Part III) and Witness (Part IV & V).

The Orrery

The Orrery begins in the month of December with Sol in Sagittarius, Saturn in the third placement of Aquarius, Jupiter beginning one quarter of the way in Sagittarius, Mars beginning one quarter in Virgo, Venus beginning in Gemini, and Mercury beginning in Aquarius.



Imagine

The Facilitator reads aloud:

The destined apocalypse is at hand. An era of peace, which has left the Wizards of the Pact decadent and delirious on their own arrogance, has entered freefall, and now comes tumbling into certain calamity. A red star burns overhead, a meteor heading towards Isha. The world goes quiet in anticipation. The world is ending, and the Wizards of the Pact must find a way to work together if they have any hope of saving their charges.

Discuss together:

- What are our goals in playing this Age?
- Are any of us secretly rooted for the world to end?
- The Palette Grid and where you'd place each topic.

Empower (Part I)

Each player chooses a Codex and completes Part I of their Codex, making choices for their wizard.

Starting with the Facilitator and going clockwise around the table, each player introduces their Wizard with his name, age, pact-fragment, familiar, appearance (including visible changes from magic), and what is publicly known about his old master.

Titles

Next, collectively answer a few questions, and assign titles to our Wizards. These titles aren't necessarily caused by the events described in the title, although they could be.

- Who is the oldest Wizard? *He is titled "Archmagus."*
- Who is the youngest Wizard? *He is titled "Neophyte."*
- One of us has long believed the world would end, and another has laughed in his face. Why do you quarrel so? Why have you not yet apologized? *One has the title "the Foolish" and the other has the title "Witness to the Truth."*
- One of us has pushed himself to the very limit trying to hold the darkness at bay, and another has allowed his Domain to crumble into ruins. Why has no one stepped in to help? Why do you still trust one another? *One has the title "the Ceaseless" and the other has the title "Thief-King."*
- Some of us have hidden away from the rest of the world to focus on our projects, while others have fashioned themselves celebrities, regents, and kings. *Those without titles may choose from amongst: "Lord of the Isles," "the Silent," "Butcher of Thyr," and "of the Tower."*

Befriend (Part II)

Look through Part II and observe your Wizard's Isle and Sanctum. Make a change or addition to the Lore of both your Isle and Sanctum to reflect the disastrous circumstances.

Choose four Companions, one for each of your Elements. You are estranged and currently not on speaking terms with any Companions chosen for a Circle with o. Create Companions either using the Companions described in your Codex or of your own creation.

Govern (Part III)

Each Wizard is the undisputed lord of his Domain. Read through the Rules of your Domain, and then turn to your Section here to make choices and prepare.

If a Wizard is Absent, that Wizard's position in the Pact is empty. The Celestial Audience should still set up his Domain and maintain it each month, but without anyone to schedule Time on it.

Each wizard's Domain begins in an Explosive Arrangement. Additionally, each Present wizard chooses one of the following:

- **The Necromancer:** A Foe of Death has already escaped the Gates. Choose any other wizard and create and place a Foe of Death in his Domain.
- **The Hierophant:** A Cult has already taken hold amongst the populace. Choose two Populace and place them in a Cult in any other wizard's Domain. Create a Prophet to lead that Cult.
- **The Warlock:** The King is dead. The Domain begins in a state of Civil War.
- **The Mariner:** A Rampaging Beast (a dragon, ideally) has stormed into any other wizard's Domain.
- **The Faustian:** Choose any Denizen created by other wizards. Set them as an Antagonist.
- **The Sage:** A fairy has snuck away from the Dreaming. Create and place a Disruptive Fairy in any other wizard's Domain.
- **The Sorcerer:** A Disruptive Arcanist has escaped your grasp. Create and place him in any other wizard's Domain.

Witness (Part IV & V)

Going around, each Wizard introduces his Watcher Role, the truth he stands for, and reads out what he will watch out for during other Wizards' scenes.

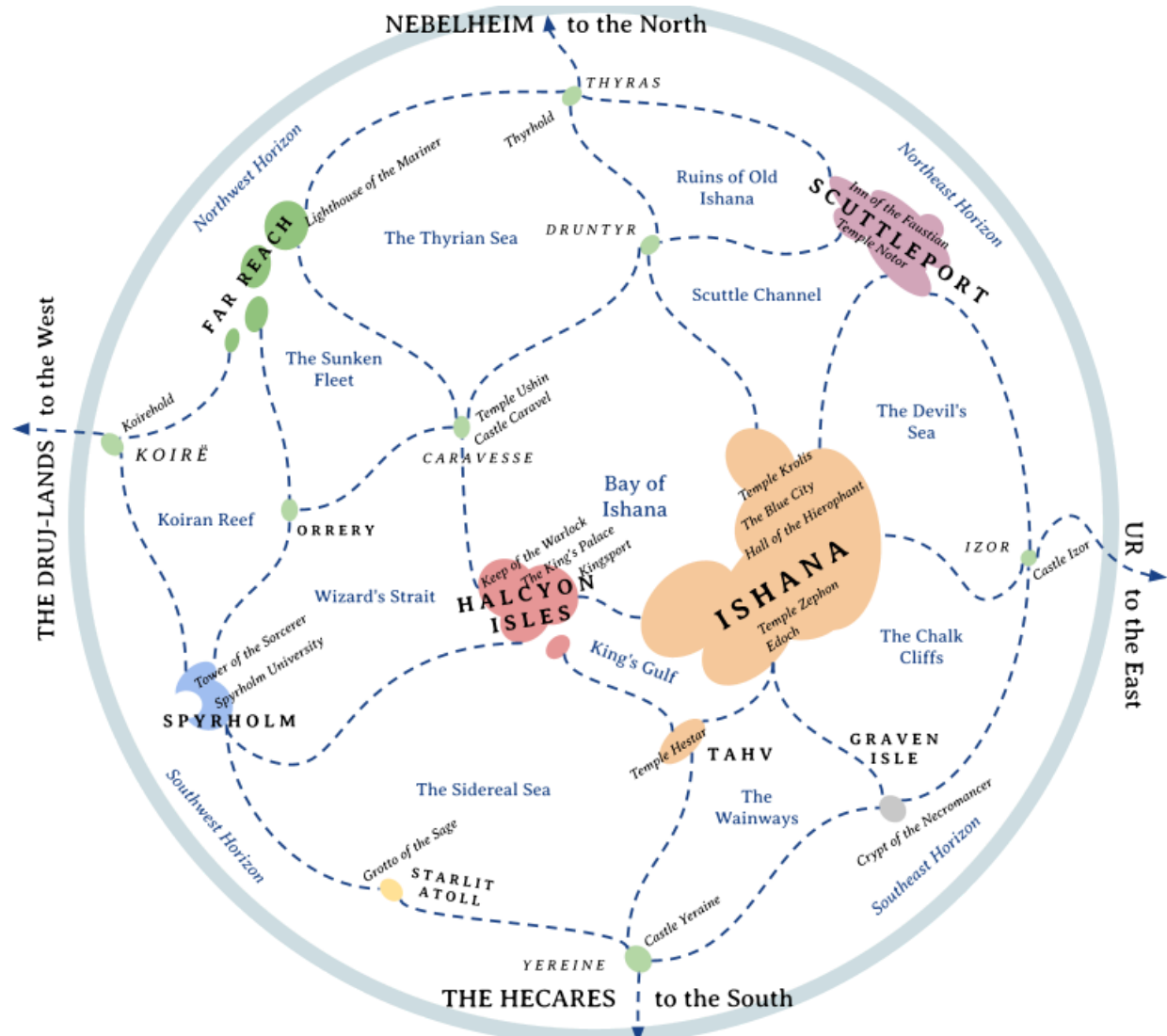
This Age contains no changes to the Rules and Lore described in Parts IV & V of the various Codexes.

Opening The Game

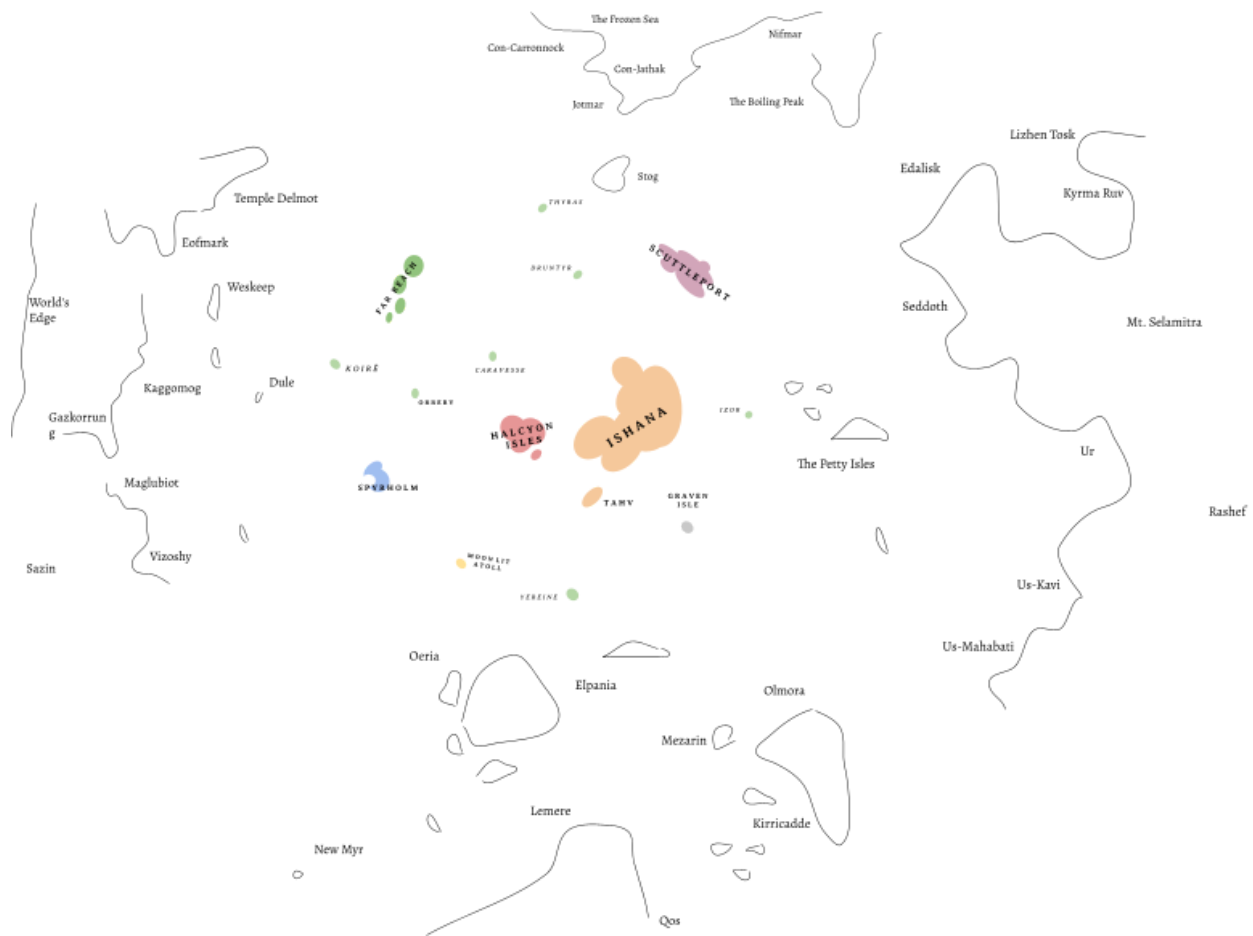
Follow the instructions for The Wizardmoot at the Orrery on page XXXX to begin the game and strategize for the next several months. Once the Wizardmoot has concluded, begin the new month.

Appendixes

A Complete Map of the Archipelago of Isha



A Complete Map of the Faraway Sea



The Text of the Seven-Part Pact

Atop the fallen star in the land of Isha, we seven Wizards, wise men of power and knowledge, hereby share in our concordat and hereinth resolve to be bound to and act in accordance with the following legislation upon our might:

1. There shall be a **Sorcerer**, who shall be known truth-watcher, and whose fragment of the Pact is that of a crown, and who will sign this document beneath the celestial body of the Sun and sit upon a throne of gold. His domain is that of the last standing tower and the knowledge contained within its Library, and ensure the Pact works together as set forth herein and continues the Great Work of his predecessors.
2. There shall be a **Sage**, who shall be known star-watcher, and whose fragment of the Pact is that of a jewel, and who will sign this document beneath the celestial body of Luna and sit upon a throne of silver. His domain is that of the dream-world and the future of the Pact, and he shall ensure its

shared alignment and balance, and ensure the Pact remains as set forth herein and the text as written remains true through time.

3. There shall be a **Faustian**, who shall be known chain-watcher, and whose fragment of the Pact is that of a key, and who will sign this document beneath the celestial body of Mercury and sit upon a throne of cinnabar. His domain is that of the Devil, the antagonist of the Pact, and he shall ensure the Devil is bound to the Pact as much as we are to it, and that his actions are limited and will not destroy the Pact as we sign it.
4. There shall be a **Mariner**, who shall be known storm-watcher, and whose fragment of the Pact is that of a stave, and who will sign this document beneath the celestial body of Venus and sit upon a throne of copper. His domain is that of the seas and skies, the winds and the waves, the clouds and shores of Isha, and the deep creatures which lie below, and the Nereid courts of the far oceans, and he shall ensure such forces are balanced against one another, and shepherd them in a state of harmonious alignment.
5. There shall be a **Warlock**, who shall be known throne-watcher, and whose fragment of the Pact is that of a sword, and who will sign this document beneath the celestial body of Mars and sit upon a throne of iron. His domain is that of the kingdom of Isha as a legal and social entity, ensuring the just and true inheritance of the crown of Isha, and that in times of war he may take up arms to defend Isha from those who threaten it, and he may act upon behalf of the King of Isha.
6. There shall be a **Hierophant**, who shall be known flame-watcher, and whose fragment of the Pact is that of a grail, and who will sign this document beneath the celestial body of Jupiter and sit upon a throne of tin. His domain is that of the four flames of the temples of Isha and the monasteries which have been built around them, and ensure they burn fairly and truthfully, and that those who seek refuge before them may do so safely, and that the teachings of the Gods may be truthfully preserved within the safety of the immortal flames.
7. There shall be a **Necromancer**, who shall be known gate-watcher, and whose fragment of the Pact is that of a skull, and who will sign this document beneath the celestial body of Saturn and sit upon a throne of lead. His domain is that of the gates of death which lie beyond the veil of life, and the countless teeming dead who lie therein, and the pathways between such gates, and he shall ensure all dead may venture through the final gate, and that as few escape as he may prevent.

Be it hereby further resolved, all Wizards agree and acknowledge that they shall bind themselves to the following laws as more particularly set forth below:

8. Each wizard shall remain a man of sound mind and body, capable of performing all the physical and emotional demands of his domain.
9. Each wizard shall appoint a prentice, an individual who shall take his mantle and responsibility in the event of his death. If a wizard's prentice precedes the wizard in death, then it shall be this wizard's responsibility to find a new prentice before his own passing.
10. No wizard shall act against the Pact, the orrery as a structure, or the mechanisms which ensure its maintenance and structure, or seek its destruction, nor will he intentionally and spuriously waste the time and energy of the Pact, through obstruction or deception.

11. Each wizard shall strive to attend a Wizardmoot beneath the orrery no less frequently than monthly, and he will not miss such a meeting, without otherwise obtaining the permission of the Archmagus, for more than three (3) consecutive calendar months.
12. A quorum of the Wizardmoot shall require the presence of no fewer than four (4) Wizards in good standing. If quorum cannot be formed, then all judgments will lie in the responsibility of the Archmagus. If the Archmagus is not present, then all judgments will lie in the responsibility of the eldest wizard present at such Wizardmoot.
13. No wizard without permission of his peers, strike against the Domain of any other wizard, nor shall any wizard damage any Domain by willful act or omission, or through magic or will render any Domain obsolete, or negligently cause its destruction, or attempt to stop another Wizard from altering his own Domain in a manner he finds appropriate.
14. No wizard shall act against another wizard with violence. No wizard shall take the life of another wizard, unless he strikes against one who has taken action in violation of the Pact. The exception shall be in the event of the judgment of the Wizardmoot as determined by the trial of the Pact.
15. No wizard shall set foot in another wizard's Sanctum without the express permission of the inviting wizard.
16. No wizard save the Hierophant shall set foot upon the soil of the Sacred Isle of Tahv, and each Wizard will take every effort to respect the laws of each Isle if he stands upon them.
17. No wizard shall intentionally hide a secret of magic, its operations or its spellcasting, from the remainder of the Pact, and all wizards shall share together the knowledge of the operations of magic.
18. No wizard shall share the secrets of magic, its operations or its spellcasting, with any individual or group unbound by the Pact, save and except for his prentices, of whom he may instruct in magic of lesser import.
19. No wizard shall abandon his Domain entirely to the whims and fate of the forces which act upon it, spending no time within his Domain for a period of a month or more, nor may he abdicate from his position under any circumstances, nor may he depart the Pact carrying with him the capacity to perform magic or the knowledge and secrets of the Pact. In the event of his departure, the Wizard must appoint a Regent to serve in his stead.
20. If there is any question as to whether a wizard has violated the Pact, he shall willingly submit himself to judgment by a quorum of his peers and receive a just and faithful accord from a jury of his fellow Wizards who will provide trial through whichever means be deemed most appropriate, as overseen by the present Archmagus and he will graciously accept such punishment as is deemed most appropriate by his peers in the event he is found to be guilty of those charges brought against him.
21. If a wizard refuses to submit himself before the judgment of the Wizardmoot, or he refuses to accept their just punishment, he shall be branded *anathema*, and must thereupon be eliminated in order to ensure the true operations of the Pact continues.
22. If a wizard dies and there is no prentice prepared as a replacement, the wizards will form quorum to find a suitable replacement. The decision will be made no less than three (3) months following the death of the wizard, and in such an event that no quorum may be reached, the Archmagus is to make a final choice.

23. New laws may be added to the Pact while the Wizardmoot is in quorum upon the unanimous consent of all wizards present.

Bibliography

Fiction

A list of fake wizard biographies...

Jonathan Strange & Mr. Norrell by Susanna Clarke

The Earthsea Cycle by Ursula Le Guin

The Defense by Vladimir Nabokov

The Name of the Rose and *Foucault's Pendulum* by Umberto Eco

Rakesfall by Vajra Chandrasekera

Piranesi by Susanna Clarke

The West Passage by Jared Pechaček

The Sandman Series by Neil Gaiman

Invisible Cities by Italo Calvino

Deathless by Catheryne Valente

The Name of the Wind by Patrick Rothfuss

The Keys to the Kingdom series by Garth Nix

The Old Kingdom series by Garth Nix

Howl's Moving Castle by Diana Wynn Jones

Witch Hat Atelier by Kamome Shirahama

Most of the *Discworld* series by Terry Pratchett, but especially *Equal Rites*, *Monstrous Regiment*, and the books concerning his Unseen University.

Theory

...and real Wizard spellbooks.

The Arcades Project by Walter Benjamin

Discipline and Punish by Michel Foucault

The Poetics of Space by Gaston Bachelard

The Dawn of Everything by David Graeber and David Wentworth

The Devil in Medieval Europe by Luther Link

Entangled Lives by Merlin Sheldrake

The Red Book by Carl Jung

Writing on Drugs by Sadie Plant

Movies

The Dark Crystal (1982)

Wizards (1979)

Howl's Moving Castle (2004)

The Boy & The Heron (2023)

The Thief & The Cobbler (1993)

The Green Knight (2021)

The Last Duel (2021)

The Raven (1963)

Other Games

Wisher, Theurgist, Fatalist by Jenna Moran

Under Hollow Hills by Meguey and Vincent Baker

ARCS by Cole Wehrle

The Quiet Year by Avery Alder

Wickedness by M Veselak

Triangle Agency by Caleb Zane Huett and Sean Ireland

Dream Askew & Dream Apart by Avery Alder and Benjamin Rosenbaum

Persuasion by Xoe Allred

The Wizard's Grimoire series by Meguey and Vincent Baker

Ars Magica by Meguey and Vincent Baker

Ars Magica by Jonathan Tweet and Mark Rein-Hagen

Ars Magica, the other ones, as well.

Changeling: The Lost and *Mage: The Ascension*

Dungeons & Dragons (but specifically only the Spell "Mordenkainen's Magnificent Mansion," which everyone loves and no one ever casts)

Magic: The Gathering

The Team

Written by Jay Dragon.

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Dedications

Thank you Vincent and Elliot Baker, for reminding me that I can stop making this game whenever I please, and in doing so, reminded me why I want to make it.

Thank you Steve Jackson, for believing in my vision of this game whole-heartedly in the moments when I thought it was unpublishable.

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Style Guide

Grammar and spelling choices are in-line with the Chicago Manual of Style.

Exceptions:

- The plural of "codex" is "codexes", not "codices."
- The plural of "appendix" is "appendixes" not "appendices"

Instructions to a player are written in 2nd person. References to a player use they/them pronouns. Reference to a player's wizard use he/him pronouns within rules text and you/your pronouns within picklists. (*be clear when you're referring to a player vs. a wizard*)

Words whose definition does not line up with the dictionary definition of the word (i.e it has some special game meaning or some special narrative meaning) are Capitalized. *Examples: The Tragedies, Domains, Foes of Death.*

The first instance of a game-mechanical word whose definition is provided in the same book is written in **bold**.

In the rulebook, the first instance of an important narrative word is written in ***bold italic***. This is not true for *The Grimoire* or for the codexes.

Game words or narrative words whose meaning is the same as a dictionary definition are left unmarked. *Examples: wizard, codex, magic, wife*

Compound narrative words are capitalized and separated by a hyphen. *Examples: Pact-Fragment, Ghoul-Callers, Pact-Law.*

The name of the game is *Seven-Part Pact* (always in ***bold italic***). The name of the in-universe object is the Seven-Part Pact (note the definite article).

Titles are Capitalized. *Examples: Gate-Keeper, Bearer of the Blade, Necromancer, the Pact.*

The names of other books within 7PP, are *italicized*. *Examples: The Book of Flames*

Headers intended to be boxes or sidenotes are marked with [box]

Footnotes are marked with brackets and labeled as footnotes. [footnote: Like this.]

When listing page numbers inside the same book, they are listed as a parenthetical inside the sentence (page XXXX). When the page number is in a separate book, it is listed as a footnote as such: [footnote: *The Book of Chains*, Part 3 — Watching The Stars, page XXXX.]

When a picklist option has both a narrative and a mechanical element (or a question), the narrative element is presented first as a complete sentence and the mechanical element is presented second in italics. The mechanical element is noted in parentheses if it's not a complete sentence.

Descriptions (for alt-text) of images, charts, graphs, etc. are written in [bright blue courier new with brackets]

"Time" is the name of the token. You "Schedule" Time and then "Spend" that Time. Avoid "a week of Time."

Lists:

- bullet point lists are *explanatory*, they are unmodifiable
- ☐ checkbox lists are participatory and unmodifiable
- arrow lists are lore lists, their contents are changed by spending Time